ENGLISH FOR POST-ACQUISITION INTEGRATION

Cross-Border M&A Integration English

Keep the business running while the organizations come together.



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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For integration consultants, workstream leaders, and international managers coordinating the post-acquisition integration of US businesses.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight post-close situations follow an international integration team working with a US business. The focus is operating the combined organization, not negotiating the acquisition price or treating national cultures as fixed personalities.

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New ownership does not rewrite every invoice instruction | Explain continuity to a customer while separating branding, contracting identity, and verified payment instructions.

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Ownership changes faster than operating habits.

After closing, consultants need to coordinate decisions without assuming that legal ownership instantly merges systems, contracts, policies, or trust. Clear English makes dependencies and authority visible while keeping customers and employees informed.

Separate closing from integration

A completed acquisition does not mean every system, process, or contract has moved. Day 1 continuity and the target operating model are different milestones.

"The transaction has closed; payroll is continuing on the existing approved process."

Ask about local practice

Teams may differ in how they challenge proposals, seek agreement, or escalate problems. Describe the observed practice rather than explaining it through nationality.

"Does silence here mean agreement, or do we need an explicit decision?"

Keep authority specific

A sponsor endorsement, consultant recommendation, and authorized operational decision can be different steps. Name the actual decision owner and required reviews.

"The sponsor supports the objective; the process change still needs the stated approval."

Report value on a defined basis

An annualized saving, an in-period result, and a forecast are different measures. Agree a baseline and avoid counting the same benefit in two workstreams.

"That is the run rate; the realized quarterly amount is reported separately."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All people, organizations, cases, figures, and documents in the exercises are fictional. Professional English practice, not legal, employment, tax, accounting, cybersecurity, or transaction advice. All decision matrices, service arrangements, dates, and approval rules in the cases are fictional. Actual integration must follow the transaction documents, current law, employment and privacy requirements, customer obligations, authorized controls, and qualified local advice. No exercise authorizes a policy change, access grant, payment change, system cutover, or workforce decision. Organizational differences are not claims about every person from a country.

The deal closed; the payroll process did not move overnight

A Read the situation

Separate legal closing, immediate operating needs, and later integration milestones.

An overseas buyer completed the acquisition of a fictional US business on Friday. On Monday, employees must be able to enter the site, receive support, and follow the existing approved payroll process. The shared HR platform is not ready, and no immediate payroll migration is authorized. Integration consultant Aya and US operations lead Marcus prioritize continuity and identify the later migration work separately.

PEOPLE / Aya: Integration consultant | Marcus: US operations lead

CONTINUITY IS A DELIBERATE FIRST-DAY RESULT

A familiar process continuing after closing is not necessarily resistance. Ask which changes are required now and which depend on later readiness.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What has been completed?

A An authorized payroll migration
B Every future operating-model change
C Legal acquisition closing
D Full HR-platform integration

2. Which process continues under the supplied plan?

A The existing approved payroll process
B An unapproved new payroll platform
C A temporary employee-funded payroll workaround
D No payroll process at all

3. What should be separated from Monday continuity?

A The fact of the completed closing
B Employee questions about immediate operations
C The later platform migration
D Site access and support availability

Answers and explanations: page 85.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

legal close

Completion of the transaction under its actual closing requirements.

IN USE confirm legal close

Day 1 readiness

Preparedness for required operations immediately after closing.

IN USE assess Day 1 readiness

business continuity

Ability to sustain required operations through change or disruption.

IN USE protect business continuity

integration management office

Team coordinating integration governance and workstreams.

IN USE establish the integration management office

workstream

Defined area of coordinated integration work.

IN USE lead the HR workstream

critical service

Service whose interruption materially affects required operations.

IN USE identify critical services

minimum operating requirement

Condition needed for the specified operation to function.

IN USE define minimum operating requirements

transition service agreement

Contract for specified temporary support during a transition.

IN USE review the transition service agreement

standalone capability

Ability to perform a function without the temporary support being replaced.

IN USE establish standalone capability

interim operating model

Temporary arrangement used during transition.

IN USE document the interim operating model

target operating model

Intended future arrangement of roles, processes, and systems.

IN USE define the target operating model

readiness checkpoint

Defined review of whether prerequisites are met.

IN USE hold a readiness checkpoint

Precision check

Legal close and completed integration are different. The supplied Monday plan preserves the existing payroll process; it does not authorize immediate migration.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

dependency

Requirement or preceding activity on which another task relies.

IN USE map the dependency

continuity owner

Person accountable for keeping a specified operation functioning.

IN USE name the continuity owner

hypercare

Time-limited heightened support after a transition.

IN USE plan hypercare coverage

service desk

Contact function handling user support requests.

IN USE brief the service desk

critical-path item

Task whose timing can constrain the overall sequence.

IN USE identify a critical-path item

Day 100 milestone

Stated later integration target, not a universal legal deadline.

IN USE review the Day 100 milestone

clarification request

Question that resolves an unclear meaning or instruction.

IN USE make a targeted clarification request

source attribution

Identification of where information came from.

IN USE preserve source attribution

working assumption

Provisional premise used while information is incomplete.

IN USE challenge a working assumption

scope boundary

Limit of the work or authority being discussed.

IN USE state the scope boundary

action owner

Named person responsible for a specified next step.

IN USE confirm the action owner

check-back

Restatement used to verify that a message was understood.

IN USE complete a check-back

Precision check

Day 1 and Day 100 are planning labels whose actual scope depends on the deal and operating plan. They do not create universal deadlines or permissions.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

SEPARATE MILESTONES

"Closing is complete; platform integration is not."

PRIORITIZE CONTINUITY

"Which services must work when employees arrive on Monday?"

PRESERVE THE CURRENT PLAN

"Payroll remains on the existing approved process."

IDENTIFY DEPENDENCY

"Migration depends on readiness checks and the required authorization."

NAME RESPONSIBILITY

"Who owns continuity if the new platform is delayed?"

EXPLAIN THE INTERIM STATE

"This is the temporary operating arrangement, not the final design."

KEEP SUPPORT VISIBLE

"Employees need one clear support route for the transition."

REPORT ACCURATELY

"We are ready for the stated Day 1 scope, not every future integration change."

Closed versus integrated

Closed refers to the completed transaction; integrated refers to the actual operational work.

Continue versus freeze forever

Continue preserves the current approved process now without promising it will never change.

Ready for what

Ready needs a defined scope; one functioning service does not establish readiness for every migration.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CLARIFY THE QUESTION

"Are you asking about the finding or the next step?"

INVITE CORRECTION

"Please correct me if I have misunderstood that detail."

ATTRIBUTE INFORMATION

"That is what the current record says; it has not been independently confirmed."

SEPARATE POSSIBILITY

"That is a possibility, not an agreed outcome."

CHECK SCOPE

"That decision sits outside my authority."

PIN DOWN RESPONSIBILITY

"Who is responsible for that specific next step?"

REPAIR MISUNDERSTANDING

"Let me restate the distinction more clearly."

CLOSE AN EXCHANGE

"We agree on the action, the owner, and the point for review."

Reported versus verified

Reported attributes information to a source; verified indicates it has been checked. Do not use the words interchangeably.

Could versus will

Could introduces a possibility. Will commits to an action or predicts an outcome; check whether that certainty is justified.

By versus at

By gives a latest time; at identifies a scheduled moment. State the time zone when people work across locations.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which Monday message is supported?

A All policies changed automatically at closing
B Integration is complete because ownership changed
C Payroll continues under the existing approved process
D Every employee moves to the new platform immediately

2. Which question identifies continuity responsibility?

A Who owns payroll operation during the transition?
B Which logo should be larger?
C Can we assume the buyer handles every detail?
D Does legal close erase the need for support?

3. What should a readiness statement include?

A Only a green color without definition
B A promise that every future change is complete
C A claim that no dependency can delay work
D The specific services and scope checked

4. Which action is not authorized by the case?

A Migrating payroll immediately
B Keeping the support route clear
C Recording the platform dependency
D Identifying the continuity owner

Answers and explanations: page 85.

The deal closed; the payroll process did not move overnight

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

target operating model / continuity owner / service desk / business continuity / readiness checkpoint / Day 1 readiness / integration management office / dependency / legal close / interim operating model

01 **Aya:** The acquisition closed on Friday. Headquarters would like Monday's message to say that everyone is now fully integrated.

02 **Marcus:** We should separate [1] _____ from the operating changes. Ownership changed, but the shared HR platform is not ready.

03 **Aya:** Then the first question is what must function when employees arrive, rather than how many new processes we can announce.

04 **Marcus:** Exactly. [2] _____ means site access, support, and the approved payroll process work within the agreed immediate scope.

05 **Aya:** Payroll currently runs through the existing approved process. No one has authorized moving it to the new platform this week.

06 **Marcus:** Keep that [3] _____ message explicit. Employees should not infer a pay-process change from a new ownership announcement.

07 **Aya:** Some colleagues may see the old process continuing as a sign that the local team is resisting the acquisition.

08 **Marcus:** It is our [4] _____, not a statement that the organization will never change. Explain its purpose and limits.

09 **Aya:** The later migration still matters, but we need to identify the testing, data, access, and approval work before scheduling it.

10 **Marcus:** Put those items in the [5] _____ map so the schedule reflects what actually has to happen first.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

11 **Aya:** Who should coordinate those items across HR, IT, finance, and the local business without taking over every operational decision?

12 **Marcus:** The [6] _____ can coordinate the workstreams while the actual functional owners retain their defined responsibilities.

13 **Aya:** We also need a named person responsible if employees cannot access the payroll support channel on Monday.

14 **Marcus:** Assign a [7] _____ and an escalation route rather than leave responsibility attached only to a department name.

15 **Aya:** The service desk needs a clear briefing on what changes now, what stays the same, and where to route unanswered questions.

16 **Marcus:** Yes. The [8] _____ should not tell employees to use a platform that has not been released or supported.

17 **Aya:** Before the later migration, we can review the actual evidence that the required tests and authorizations are complete.

18 **Marcus:** That is the purpose of a [9] _____. A target date should not substitute for verified readiness.

19 **Aya:** I will revise the message: the transaction has closed, immediate operations continue under the stated plan, and migration work remains scheduled for review.

20 **Marcus:** Good. The [10] _____ can remain our destination without being announced as a completed fact on the first working day.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. legal close | 2. Day 1 readiness | 3. business continuity | 4. interim operating model | 5. dependency | 6. integration management office | 7. continuity owner | 8. service desk | 9. readiness checkpoint | 10. target operating model

The logo changed before the support route

F Say it

The employee portal has new branding, but the approved support process remains unchanged. The shared support platform has not launched.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

process / changed / unchanged / launched

Employee: "The branding has [1] _____."

Consultant: "The approved support route remains [2] _____."

Employee: "The shared platform has not [3] _____."

Consultant: "Use the current approved [4] _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. changed | 2. unchanged | 3. launched | 4. process

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected exchange and distinguish closed, ready for Day 1, interim, and fully integrated.

2. Switch roles and deliver the Monday message without announcing an unauthorized payroll change.

3. Complete the four-line follow-up with the supplied choices. Check the explanations, then read the corrected exchange twice, changing roles.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Sponsor support is not process-change authorization

A Read the situation

Separate coordination, consultation, and approval when a workstream decision crosses functions.

A global sponsor supports standardizing customer credit terms. The fictional integration decision matrix requires finance ownership, local legal consultation, and steering-committee approval before the US process changes. Consultant Leo coordinates the proposal but cannot approve it. The sales workstream asks to implement immediately because the sponsor liked the concept. None of the required decision steps has been completed.

PEOPLE / Leo: Integration consultant | Priya: Sales workstream lead

ASK WHO DECIDES WITHOUT SOUNDING TERRITORIAL

Decision clarity prevents duplicate instructions and premature implementation. A consultant can keep momentum while respecting the actual approval route.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What did the sponsor provide?

A Local legal review

B Authorization from every process owner

C Support for the standardization concept

D Completed steering approval

2. Who coordinates but cannot approve the change?

A The authorized finance owner

B The local legal reviewer

C Leo

D The steering committee under the supplied matrix

3. Which sequence is required before implementation here?

A Sales preference alone

B Sponsor enthusiasm alone

C A new slide title

D Finance ownership, local legal consultation, and steering approval

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

decision rights

Defined authority over specified decisions.

IN USE clarify decision rights

governance charter

Document defining the program's governance arrangements.

IN USE review the governance charter

steering committee

Body directing specified program decisions under its mandate.

IN USE seek steering-committee approval

executive sponsor

Senior supporter accountable for the initiative under the defined role.

IN USE brief the executive sponsor

process owner

Person accountable for a defined operational process.

IN USE confirm the process owner

RACI matrix

Responsibility map distinguishing responsible, accountable, consulted, and informed roles.

IN USE use the RACI matrix

accountable role

Role answerable for the specified outcome under the actual matrix.

IN USE identify the accountable role

consulted stakeholder

Person whose input is sought under the stated process.

IN USE involve consulted stakeholders

informed stakeholder

Person kept updated without necessarily making the decision.

IN USE notify informed stakeholders

approval gate

Point requiring the specified authorization before proceeding.

IN USE complete the approval gate

escalation path

Route for raising unresolved issues to the appropriate authority.

IN USE use the escalation path

decision log

Record of decisions, rationale, authority, and conditions.

IN USE update the decision log

Precision check

The sponsor supports the objective. Under the supplied matrix, finance ownership, local legal consultation, and steering approval are still required before implementation.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

issue log

Record of current problems needing resolution.

IN USE maintain the issue log

RAID log

Program record of risks, assumptions, issues, and dependencies under the stated convention.

IN USE reconcile the RAID log

change request

Formal proposal to alter an agreed scope, process, or plan.

IN USE submit a change request

delegated authority

Decision power specifically granted to another role.

IN USE verify delegated authority

cross-functional dependency

Requirement linking work across functional teams.

IN USE resolve cross-functional dependencies

decision latency

Time between raising a decision need and resolving it.

IN USE reduce decision latency

clarification request

Question that resolves an unclear meaning or instruction.

IN USE make a targeted clarification request

source attribution

Identification of where information came from.

IN USE preserve source attribution

working assumption

Provisional premise used while information is incomplete.

IN USE challenge a working assumption

scope boundary

Limit of the work or authority being discussed.

IN USE state the scope boundary

action owner

Named person responsible for a specified next step.

IN USE confirm the action owner

check-back

Restatement used to verify that a message was understood.

IN USE complete a check-back

Precision check

A RACI or similar matrix describes the actual chosen governance arrangement. Acronyms and role labels do not create legal or operational authority by themselves.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

SEPARATE SUPPORT AND APPROVAL

"The sponsor supports the concept; the process change is not yet authorized."

NAME THE OWNER

"Finance owns this process under the agreed matrix."

INVITE THE RIGHT REVIEW

"Local legal input is required before the decision."

DEFINE YOUR ROLE

"I can coordinate the proposal, but I cannot approve it."

KEEP MOMENTUM

"Let us name the decision owner and the information needed."

USE THE ESCALATION ROUTE

"If the decision is delayed, we escalate through the stated path."

RECORD THE CONDITION

"The decision log must retain any conditions attached to approval."

PREVENT DUPLICATE INSTRUCTIONS

"We need one authorized instruction for the affected teams."

Consulted versus approving

Consultation provides input; approval exercises the specified decision authority.

Supports versus authorizes

Supports expresses endorsement; authorizes permits the relevant action within the actual role.

Responsible for coordinating

Coordination can move work forward without conferring authority to make every underlying decision.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CLARIFY THE QUESTION

"Are you asking about the finding or the next step?"

INVITE CORRECTION

"Please correct me if I have misunderstood that detail."

ATTRIBUTE INFORMATION

"That is what the current record says; it has not been independently confirmed."

SEPARATE POSSIBILITY

"That is a possibility, not an agreed outcome."

CHECK SCOPE

"That decision sits outside my authority."

PIN DOWN RESPONSIBILITY

"Who is responsible for that specific next step?"

REPAIR MISUNDERSTANDING

"Let me restate the distinction more clearly."

CLOSE AN EXCHANGE

"We agree on the action, the owner, and the point for review."

Reported versus verified

Reported attributes information to a source; verified indicates it has been checked. Do not use the words interchangeably.

Could versus will

Could introduces a possibility. Will commits to an action or predicts an outcome; check whether that certainty is justified.

By versus at

By gives a latest time; at identifies a scheduled moment. State the time zone when people work across locations.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response preserves momentum and governance?

A Implement because the sponsor smiled at the slide
B Let each workstream choose its own terms
C Record approval before anyone decides
D Coordinate the required reviews and decision request

2. Which statement accurately describes Leo's role?

A He alone changes customer contracts
B He coordinates the proposal without approving it
C He may override the decision matrix
D He replaces local legal counsel

3. What belongs in a decision log?

A Actual decision, authority, rationale, and conditions
B Only a positive color
C A proposed outcome labeled complete
D An unsupported claim that silence means consent

4. What should happen if a required decision is delayed?

A Ask employees to infer a policy
B Use the stated escalation path
C Treat delay as automatic approval
D Bypass every reviewer

Answers and explanations: page 87.

Sponsor support is not process-change authorization

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

escalation path / delegated authority / consulted stakeholder / decision rights / executive sponsor / approval gate / change request / decision log / process owner / cross-functional dependency

01 **Priya:** The sponsor liked our standard credit-terms proposal. Sales wants to start using it in the US business tomorrow.

02 **Leo:** We need to distinguish support from [1] _____. The agreed matrix still requires finance ownership, local legal input, and steering approval.

03 **Priya:** The sponsor is senior, so I assumed the positive reaction replaced the remaining steps.

04 **Leo:** The [2] _____ supports the objective, but we have not received an instruction changing the stated approval route.

05 **Priya:** Finance needs to assess collection risk and how the proposed terms affect the current customer process.

06 **Leo:** Yes. Finance is the [3] _____ under this matrix, rather than merely a team we inform after implementation.

07 **Priya:** Local legal counsel also needs to check the actual customer arrangements before we assume the global wording can be used unchanged.

08 **Leo:** That is the required [4] _____ role here. Consultation is not optional simply because the desired outcome is familiar.

09 **Priya:** What can you decide as the integration consultant, and what needs to stay with the functional and steering roles?

10 **Leo:** I can coordinate the [5] _____, assemble the dependencies, and track the decision. I cannot approve this process change myself.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

11 **Priya:** We need a clear request with the proposed scope, affected customers, risks, and the question the committee must answer.

12 **Leo:** That will make the [6] _____ more useful than sending a general slide and hoping everyone interprets the next step the same way.

13 **Priya:** If a reviewer does not respond quickly, sales still needs a way to raise the timing risk.

14 **Leo:** Use the agreed [7] _____. We can escalate the delay without treating silence as consent.

15 **Priya:** The sales and finance leads should not send conflicting instructions to the US team while the decision remains open.

16 **Leo:** Correct. The [8] _____ needs one coordinated status and an eventual authorized instruction.

17 **Priya:** Once the committee decides, we should record exactly what was approved and any conditions, rather than only marking the slide green.

18 **Leo:** Put that in the [9] _____, along with the owner responsible for communicating and implementing the authorized change.

19 **Priya:** I will tell sales that the concept is supported and the required review and approval are still outstanding.

20 **Leo:** Good. That reduces confusion about [10] _____ while keeping the proposal moving through the people who can properly decide it.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. decision rights | 2. executive sponsor | 3. process owner | 4. consulted stakeholder | 5. change request | 6. approval gate | 7. escalation path | 8. cross-functional dependency | 9. decision log | 10. delegated authority

Consultation was recorded as approval

F Say it

Local legal counsel provides comments on a proposal. The steering committee has not decided. A status slide incorrectly says approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

outstanding / record / authority / comments

Lead: "Legal has provided [1] _____."

Consultant: "Steering approval remains [2] _____."

Lead: "The status label overstated the [3] _____."

Consultant: "Correct the decision [4] _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. comments | 2. outstanding | 3. authority | 4. record

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected exchange and distinguish supports, consults, coordinates, and approves.

2. Switch roles and state the supplied decision sequence without inventing delegated authority.

3. Complete the four-line follow-up with the supplied choices. Check the explanations, then read the corrected exchange twice, changing roles.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

That timeline will not work is a request to test the plan

A Read the situation

Respond to direct challenge, identify the underlying constraint, and establish a shared discussion norm.

In the acquired US team, operations lead Jordan says the proposed Tuesday supplier cutover will not work because quality approval is still outstanding. Integration consultant Lina initially hears the direct objection as rejection of headquarters. Their previous organizations used different meeting habits. The actual issue is an uncompleted approval, not established hostility. They need explicit agreement and a clear boundary against personal attacks.

PEOPLE / Jordan: US operations lead | Lina: Integration consultant

INTERPRET THE SPECIFIC EXCHANGE, NOT A NATIONALITY

Some teams test a proposal aloud; others expect concerns to be resolved before a meeting. Ask what the speaker means and what evidence supports the objection. Directness does not excuse personal abuse.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What concrete constraint does Jordan identify?

A The local team refuses every change
B Quality approval is outstanding
C Headquarters has no legal ownership
D The supplier has already failed every test

2. What is not established by the direct objection?

A An unresolved approval
B A difference in meeting habits
C Hostile intent toward headquarters
D A challenge to the timeline

3. What should the team make explicit?

A Permission to attack colleagues personally
B The concern, decision status, and discussion boundary
C A rule that silence always means approval
D A national stereotype about every employee

Answers and explanations: page 89.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

working norm

Agreed way a team conducts recurring work.

IN USE establish working norms

challenge protocol

Agreed method for questioning proposals or assumptions.

IN USE define a challenge protocol

constructive dissent

Reasoned disagreement intended to improve a decision.

IN USE invite constructive dissent

psychological safety

Ability to raise questions or concerns without inappropriate interpersonal punishment.

IN USE support psychological safety

face-saving language

Wording that preserves dignity while addressing a difficult point.

IN USE use face-saving language

intent clarification

Question checking what a speaker means or aims to do.

IN USE seek intent clarification

impact statement

Description of how an action or message affects the work.

IN USE make an impact statement

decision norm

Shared expectation for how agreement and decisions are established.

IN USE clarify the decision norm

explicit agreement

Clearly stated acceptance rather than inferred assent.

IN USE obtain explicit agreement

tacit assumption

Unspoken premise influencing interpretation or action.

IN USE surface a tacit assumption

local constraint

Requirement or limitation affecting the local operation.

IN USE identify a local constraint

integration friction

Difficulty arising as organizations combine practices and expectations.

IN USE address integration friction

Precision check

Jordan challenges the Tuesday cutover because quality approval is outstanding. That does not establish opposition to the acquisition or personal hostility.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

shared vocabulary

Agreed meanings for recurring terms across teams.

IN USE establish a shared vocabulary

pre-read

Material circulated before a meeting for preparation.

IN USE circulate a focused pre-read

disagreement boundary

Limit separating legitimate challenge from personal attack or misconduct.

IN USE state the disagreement boundary

repair statement

Wording correcting a misunderstanding or relational impact.

IN USE offer a repair statement

alignment check

Explicit test of whether participants share the same understanding.

IN USE conduct an alignment check

meeting closeout

Final confirmation of decisions, open issues, and actions.

IN USE complete the meeting closeout

clarification request

Question that resolves an unclear meaning or instruction.

IN USE make a targeted clarification request

source attribution

Identification of where information came from.

IN USE preserve source attribution

working assumption

Provisional premise used while information is incomplete.

IN USE challenge a working assumption

scope boundary

Limit of the work or authority being discussed.

IN USE state the scope boundary

action owner

Named person responsible for a specified next step.

IN USE confirm the action owner

check-back

Restatement used to verify that a message was understood.

IN USE complete a check-back

Precision check

Do not excuse harassment or personal attacks as culture. Clarify meaning, require evidence, and maintain the actual workplace conduct standards.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

INVITE THE CONSTRAINT

"Which part of the Tuesday plan will fail, and why?"

CLARIFY INTENT

"Are you challenging the date or the overall integration goal?"

RESPOND FIRMLY

"We can challenge the proposal without attacking the people who prepared it."

PRESERVE DIGNITY

"I may have read your direct wording differently than you intended."

NAME THE BLOCKER

"Quality approval is still outstanding."

SEPARATE SUPPORT AND READINESS

"We support the goal, but this dependency is unresolved."

CHECK AGREEMENT

"Please state whether you agree with the next step or have a remaining objection."

CLOSE PRECISELY

"We have agreed to resolve the approval issue, not to proceed Tuesday regardless."

Will not work versus will not cooperate

The first can challenge feasibility; the second states refusal. Do not substitute one meaning without checking.

Silence versus consent

Silence may have several meanings. Use the actual decision process and seek explicit agreement where needed.

Direct versus disrespectful

Direct language can be task-focused; personal attacks or discriminatory conduct are a different issue.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CLARIFY THE QUESTION

"Are you asking about the finding or the next step?"

INVITE CORRECTION

"Please correct me if I have misunderstood that detail."

ATTRIBUTE INFORMATION

"That is what the current record says; it has not been independently confirmed."

SEPARATE POSSIBILITY

"That is a possibility, not an agreed outcome."

CHECK SCOPE

"That decision sits outside my authority."

PIN DOWN RESPONSIBILITY

"Who is responsible for that specific next step?"

REPAIR MISUNDERSTANDING

"Let me restate the distinction more clearly."

CLOSE AN EXCHANGE

"We agree on the action, the owner, and the point for review."

Reported versus verified

Reported attributes information to a source; verified indicates it has been checked. Do not use the words interchangeably.

Could versus will

Could introduces a possibility. Will commits to an action or predicts an outcome; check whether that certainty is justified.

By versus at

By gives a latest time; at identifies a scheduled moment. State the time zone when people work across locations.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response best clarifies the objection?

A Your objection proves disloyalty
B We should proceed because the wording was blunt
C Is the issue the Tuesday date or the integration goal?
D Why does your whole country resist change?

2. Which sentence protects the discussion boundary?

A Headquarters proposals cannot be questioned
B Challenge the plan with evidence, not the people
C Every insult is acceptable if it is direct
D Local staff may never disagree publicly

3. What should replace inferred consent?

A A national assumption about politeness
B A positive slide color with no decision
C A clear statement of agreement or remaining objection
D A guess based on who stayed quiet

4. Which closeout matches the facts?

A Record unanimous readiness despite the blocker
B Resolve quality approval before deciding the cutover
C Proceed Tuesday regardless of approval
D Cancel the acquisition because of one objection

Answers and explanations: page 89.

That timeline will not work is a request to test the plan

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

pre-read / challenge protocol / local constraint / meeting closeout / shared vocabulary / working norm / constructive dissent / repair statement / explicit agreement / disagreement boundary

01 **Jordan:** That Tuesday cutover will not work. We still do not have quality approval, and the schedule treats it as complete.

02 **Lina:** I want to check your meaning. Is this [1] _____ about the date, or are you objecting to the integration goal itself?

03 **Jordan:** The date is the problem. I support the change, but the local quality team has not approved the supplier transition.

04 **Lina:** Then the [2] _____ needs to be visible. I initially heard the direct wording as a rejection of headquarters.

05 **Jordan:** In our previous meetings, we tested proposals aloud. A strong objection to a plan was not meant as an attack on its author.

06 **Lina:** Our earlier [3] _____ was to resolve most objections before the meeting, so the same wording landed differently for me.

07 **Jordan:** We can adapt without making people hide a real blocker. I would rather explain the approval gap than let the schedule fail.

08 **Lina:** Agreed. Let us use a [4] _____: name the issue, explain the evidence, and identify what decision or action is needed.

09 **Jordan:** That would also help distinguish a specific objection from a vague statement that everything about the integration is wrong.

10 **Lina:** Yes, and we need a [5] _____. Challenge the proposal firmly, but do not attack the people or make assumptions about their competence or nationality.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

11 **Jordan:** I can restate my point: the Tuesday plan depends on quality approval, which is still outstanding, so readiness is not established.

12 **Lina:** Thank you. My [6] _____ is that I read your intent too broadly. The constraint is legitimate, and we should address it directly.

13 **Jordan:** Some colleagues stayed silent after the first discussion. We should not assume that means they accepted the date.

14 **Lina:** Correct. We need [7] _____ on the next action and the eventual decision, using the actual approval process.

15 **Jordan:** A short note before the next meeting could identify the pending approval, its owner, and the evidence needed to resolve it.

16 **Lina:** That [8] _____ will help both teams prepare without requiring concerns to disappear before they can be discussed.

17 **Jordan:** We also use ready differently. Sales means the supplier is willing, while quality means the required approval is complete.

18 **Lina:** Then build a [9] _____ around those statuses. A willing supplier and an approved transition are not the same thing.

19 **Jordan:** Our next step is to resolve the quality question and then decide the cutover through the proper authority.

20 **Lina:** I will record that in the [10] _____. We have aligned on the action, not agreed to proceed Tuesday regardless of readiness.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. constructive dissent | 2. local constraint | 3. working norm | 4. challenge protocol | 5. disagreement boundary | 6. repair statement | 7. explicit agreement | 8. pre-read | 9. shared vocabulary | 10. meeting closeout

Silence was recorded as approval

F Say it

A meeting ends without an explicit decision. Two participants remain silent. The required approval has not been given.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

open / stated / approval / check

Consultant: "Silence does not establish [1] _____."

Lead: "We need an explicit alignment [2] _____."

Consultant: "Any remaining objection should be [3] _____."

Lead: "The decision remains [4] _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. approval | 2. check | 3. stated | 4. open

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected exchange and practice the intent clarification without adding a national stereotype.

2. Switch roles and state the blocker, evidence, owner question, and next decision using the supplied facts.

3. Complete the four-line follow-up with the supplied choices. Check the explanations, then read the corrected exchange twice, changing roles.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A new title does not determine overtime status

A Read the situation

Explain a proposed HR change while preserving local review, current instructions, and employee trust.

The integration team proposes changing a US role title from operations coordinator to operations manager. A headquarters spreadsheet assumes the new title makes the role exempt from overtime. HR lead Denise has not completed the required review of actual duties, compensation, and applicable federal and state requirements. Consultant Ken must correct the assumption. No payroll-classification or benefits change has been approved, and the existing approved time-recording process remains in place.

PEOPLE / Ken: Integration consultant | Denise: US HR lead

CONSISTENT PRINCIPLES DO NOT REQUIRE IDENTICAL LOCAL RULES

Global titles and templates can aid coordination, but local employment requirements and actual role duties still matter. Give employees verified information instead of broad promises about future changes.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What change is proposed?

A An approved benefits reduction
B A confirmed payroll reclassification
C A role-title change
D A completed legal exemption determination

2. Why is the spreadsheet assumption unsupported?

A A job title alone does not determine exemption
B Every manager title is automatically exempt
C All salaried jobs are automatically exempt everywhere
D Local requirements disappear after acquisition

3. What process currently remains in place?

A Existing approved time recording
B Automatic deletion of time records
C An unapproved global payroll setting
D No recording until review ends

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

job architecture

Framework organizing roles, levels, and titles.

IN USE align job architecture

role mapping

Comparison of jobs across organizational structures.

IN USE complete role mapping

job title

Label identifying a role without determining every legal status.

IN USE harmonize job titles

actual duties

Work genuinely performed in the role.

IN USE review actual duties

exempt classification

Status under specified legal pay requirements after the relevant assessment.

IN USE assess exempt classification

nonexempt classification

Status subject to the relevant applicable pay protections and requirements.

IN USE verify nonexempt classification

salary basis

Method of compensation relevant under certain legal tests.

IN USE review the salary basis

overtime eligibility

Entitlement under the actual applicable pay requirements.

IN USE assess overtime eligibility

timekeeping

Recording work time under the applicable process.

IN USE maintain accurate timekeeping

policy harmonization

Coordinating policies while respecting relevant differences and requirements.

IN USE plan policy harmonization

local-law review

Qualified assessment of requirements in the relevant jurisdiction.

IN USE obtain local-law review

benefits enrollment

Process of selecting or joining employee benefit arrangements.

IN USE coordinate benefits enrollment

Precision check

A manager title does not by itself establish exempt status. The actual requirements and role facts need qualified review; no classification change is authorized here.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

paid time off

Leave entitlement or policy under the actual applicable terms.

IN USE clarify paid-time-off arrangements

employee communication

Message explaining relevant workplace information.

IN USE approve employee communications

retention concern

Risk that employees may leave or disengage during transition.

IN USE address retention concerns

consultation requirement

Obligation to seek input under the relevant law or process.

IN USE verify consultation requirements

personnel data

Information relating to employees and their employment.

IN USE protect personnel data

approved change notice

Authorized communication of an actual workplace change.

IN USE issue an approved change notice

clarification request

Question that resolves an unclear meaning or instruction.

IN USE make a targeted clarification request

source attribution

Identification of where information came from.

IN USE preserve source attribution

working assumption

Provisional premise used while information is incomplete.

IN USE challenge a working assumption

scope boundary

Limit of the work or authority being discussed.

IN USE state the scope boundary

action owner

Named person responsible for a specified next step.

IN USE confirm the action owner

check-back

Restatement used to verify that a message was understood.

IN USE complete a check-back

Precision check

Do not infer a universal rule from one federal fact sheet. State and local requirements, actual duties, compensation, agreements, and institutional processes may matter. No threshold or employee classification is decided in this exercise.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CHALLENGE THE ASSUMPTION

"The title change does not establish overtime status."

REQUEST THE FACTS

"We need the actual duties and compensation information for the review."

PROTECT CURRENT INSTRUCTIONS

"Continue the existing approved time-recording process."

SEPARATE WORKSTREAMS

"Title alignment and payroll classification are different decisions."

AVOID AN UNSUPPORTED PROMISE

"No change is approved at present; I cannot promise that nothing will ever change."

ROUTE LEGAL QUESTIONS

"The applicable requirements need qualified local review."

LIMIT DATA ACCESS

"Share personnel information only through the authorized process."

CLOSE THE LOOP

"Employees should receive an approved notice when an actual decision is made."

Proposed versus effective

Proposed describes a possible change; effective identifies a change actually in force under the relevant process.

Title versus classification

A title is an organizational label; classification concerns the actual legal and policy assessment.

No change approved versus no change ever

The first reports current status; the second promises an unknown future outcome.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CLARIFY THE QUESTION

"Are you asking about the finding or the next step?"

INVITE CORRECTION

"Please correct me if I have misunderstood that detail."

ATTRIBUTE INFORMATION

"That is what the current record says; it has not been independently confirmed."

SEPARATE POSSIBILITY

"That is a possibility, not an agreed outcome."

CHECK SCOPE

"That decision sits outside my authority."

PIN DOWN RESPONSIBILITY

"Who is responsible for that specific next step?"

REPAIR MISUNDERSTANDING

"Let me restate the distinction more clearly."

CLOSE AN EXCHANGE

"We agree on the action, the owner, and the point for review."

Reported versus verified

Reported attributes information to a source; verified indicates it has been checked. Do not use the words interchangeably.

Could versus will

Could introduces a possibility. Will commits to an action or predicts an outcome; check whether that certainty is justified.

By versus at

By gives a latest time; at identifies a scheduled moment. State the time zone when people work across locations.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which correction should be made to the spreadsheet?

A Every operations manager must be exempt
B Salary alone settles every case
C Acquisition automatically replaces local requirements
D Title mapping does not establish exempt status

2. Which employee message is accurate?

A Your benefits can never change
B The new title removes every overtime entitlement
C No classification change is approved; follow current time recording
D Stop recording time immediately

3. What should HR examine?

A Actual role facts and applicable requirements
B Only the preferred global title
C Only whether the spreadsheet cell is green
D A rule from an unrelated country without review

4. How should personnel records be shared?

A As proof that ownership cancels privacy duties
B Through the authorized access and privacy process
C With everyone on the integration mailing list
D In an unrestricted public folder

Answers and explanations: page 91.

A new title does not determine overtime status

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

job title / personnel data / Local-law review / salary basis / actual duties / job architecture / Policy harmonization / employee communication / timekeeping / exempt classification

01 **Ken:** The global role map changes operations coordinator to operations manager. The spreadsheet automatically labels the new title exempt.

02 **Denise:** That assumption needs correction. A [1] _____ does not determine the applicable overtime classification.

03 **Ken:** The title mapping was intended to align levels across the group, not to complete a legal assessment of each US role.

04 **Denise:** Then keep [2] _____ separate from payroll classification in both the spreadsheet and the employee explanation.

05 **Ken:** What information does the proper review need before anyone changes the employee record or payroll setting?

06 **Denise:** We need the [3] _____, compensation information, and applicable requirements, assessed through the authorized HR and legal process.

07 **Ken:** Being paid a salary also should not be treated as a universal shortcut to an exemption conclusion.

08 **Denise:** Correct. The [4] _____ and other requirements must be reviewed in the actual context rather than assumed from one label.

09 **Ken:** I will remove the automatic conclusion and mark the classification field as awaiting the required review.

10 **Denise:** Good. No [5] _____ change has been approved here, and the title proposal should not be used as authorization to make one.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

11 **Ken:** Employees have asked whether they should stop using the current time-recording process once the new organization chart appears.

12 **Denise:** Tell them to continue the approved [6] _____ process. A proposed chart does not cancel current instructions.

13 **Ken:** We also have different leave and benefits arrangements across the two organizations. The global template does not resolve those differences.

14 **Denise:** [7] _____ needs its own review, including relevant local requirements and any consultation or approval obligations.

15 **Ken:** The local-law questions should go to the qualified advisers rather than be answered from a general headquarters presentation.

16 **Denise:** Exactly. [8] _____ is necessary before we make claims about what is required or permitted for these employees.

17 **Ken:** Some employees want reassurance that nothing about their work or benefits will ever change. I do not have authority to promise that.

18 **Denise:** Give an accurate [9] _____: no change is approved at present, and actual decisions will be communicated through the authorized process.

19 **Ken:** I will also make sure the role records and compensation details are shared only with the people authorized for the review.

20 **Denise:** Protect the [10] _____. The integration need does not justify sending sensitive employee information to every person on the program mailing list.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. job title | 2. job architecture | 3. actual duties | 4. salary basis | 5. exempt classification | 6. timekeeping | 7. Policy harmonization | 8. Local-law review | 9. employee communication | 10. personnel data

The organization chart was mistaken for a payroll instruction

F Say it

A proposed organization chart uses new titles. No payroll classification change is approved, and current timekeeping instructions remain effective.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

incomplete / authorization / title / process

Employee: "The chart shows a proposed [1] _____."

HR: "The classification review remains [2] _____."

Employee: "I should continue the approved timekeeping [3] _____."

HR: "An actual change needs the required [4] _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. title | 2. incomplete | 3. process | 4. authorization

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected exchange and distinguish title alignment, legal classification, and payroll implementation.

2. Switch roles and give the current employee message without promising permanent unchanged terms.

3. Complete the four-line follow-up with the supplied choices. Check the explanations, then read the corrected exchange twice, changing roles.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Successful login does not prove invoice posting works

A Read the situation

Explain a hidden system dependency and distinguish technical readiness from a go-live decision.

The integration team has tested employee login to the new identity platform successfully. A scheduled invoice-posting job still uses a legacy service account and has not passed an end-to-end test on the new setup. IT lead Fatima and integration consultant Eric review the planned retirement of the legacy identity service. No go-live approval is supplied, and broad shared-administrator access is not an approved workaround.

PEOPLE / Eric: Integration consultant | Fatima: IT integration lead

TRANSLATE THE DEPENDENCY INTO BUSINESS IMPACT

A nontechnical sponsor needs to understand which business process could fail, not merely hear that an interface remains amber. Preserve the security controls while explaining the decision.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which test has passed?

A Employee login to the new identity platform
B End-to-end invoice posting on the new setup
C Complete retirement of every legacy account
D Approval of shared-administrator access

2. What dependency remains?

A The new platform is already retired
B The invoice job uses a legacy service account
C Every user lacks a new login
D The acquired business has no invoices

3. Which action is not approved?

A Broad shared-administrator access as a workaround
B Explaining the dependency
C Performing authorized readiness review
D Identifying business impact

Answers and explanations: page 93.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

cutover

Controlled transition from one operating setup to another.

IN USE plan the cutover

system migration

Transfer of applications, data, or operations to a different setup.

IN USE sequence the system migration

identity provider

Service managing authentication identity under the actual architecture.

IN USE verify identity-provider dependencies

single sign-on

Authentication arrangement allowing access across approved services.

IN USE test single sign-on

service account

Identity used by an application or automated process.

IN USE review service-account access

access entitlement

Permission assigned to a user or system identity.

IN USE validate access entitlements

least privilege

Limiting access to what is needed for the authorized task.

IN USE maintain least privilege

user acceptance testing

Business-user verification against agreed acceptance requirements.

IN USE complete user acceptance testing

end-to-end test

Test covering the relevant full process across connected components.

IN USE run an end-to-end test

reconciliation

Comparison confirming agreement between relevant records or outputs.

IN USE perform transaction reconciliation

cutover window

Planned period for the controlled transition.

IN USE confirm the cutover window

rollback plan

Approved method for returning to a prior workable state if needed.

IN USE validate the rollback plan

Precision check

A passed employee-login test does not establish that the invoice job works. The legacy service-account dependency must be resolved and tested within the authorized plan.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

go/no-go decision

Explicit authorization to proceed or not proceed at a defined point.

IN USE make the go/no-go decision

change freeze

Defined restriction on changes during a sensitive period.

IN USE observe the change freeze

legacy dependency

Reliance on a component of the earlier setup.

IN USE identify the legacy dependency

interface mapping

Definition of how information moves between connected systems.

IN USE verify interface mapping

data integrity

Accuracy and consistency of data under the relevant process.

IN USE protect data integrity

segregation of duties

Separation of incompatible responsibilities under the control framework.

IN USE preserve segregation of duties

clarification request

Question that resolves an unclear meaning or instruction.

IN USE make a targeted clarification request

source attribution

Identification of where information came from.

IN USE preserve source attribution

working assumption

Provisional premise used while information is incomplete.

IN USE challenge a working assumption

scope boundary

Limit of the work or authority being discussed.

IN USE state the scope boundary

action owner

Named person responsible for a specified next step.

IN USE confirm the action owner

check-back

Restatement used to verify that a message was understood.

IN USE complete a check-back

Precision check

This is a communication scenario, not a technical migration procedure. No access change, control bypass, legacy retirement, or go-live action is authorized by the exercise.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

TRANSLATE THE RISK

"Employees can sign in, but invoice posting still depends on the old service."

LIMIT THE STATUS

"Login testing passed; end-to-end business testing has not."

NAME THE DEPENDENCY

"The scheduled job still uses a legacy service account."

PRESERVE CONTROLS

"We need an authorized fix, not broad shared-administrator access."

DEFINE ACCEPTANCE

"Which business outputs must reconcile before signoff?"

CLARIFY FALLBACK

"Who owns the approved rollback decision and process?"

SEPARATE DATE AND PERMISSION

"A scheduled window is not go-live authorization."

CLOSE THE DECISION

"Report the unresolved dependency before the go/no-go review."

Login works versus process works

Authentication success verifies one component, not every downstream business transaction.

Scheduled versus authorized

A calendar slot reserves time; authorization permits the actual change under the process.

Retire versus disable temporarily

These describe different operational actions whose scope and controls must be explicit.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CLARIFY THE QUESTION

"Are you asking about the finding or the next step?"

INVITE CORRECTION

"Please correct me if I have misunderstood that detail."

ATTRIBUTE INFORMATION

"That is what the current record says; it has not been independently confirmed."

SEPARATE POSSIBILITY

"That is a possibility, not an agreed outcome."

CHECK SCOPE

"That decision sits outside my authority."

PIN DOWN RESPONSIBILITY

"Who is responsible for that specific next step?"

REPAIR MISUNDERSTANDING

"Let me restate the distinction more clearly."

CLOSE AN EXCHANGE

"We agree on the action, the owner, and the point for review."

Reported versus verified

Reported attributes information to a source; verified indicates it has been checked. Do not use the words interchangeably.

Could versus will

Could introduces a possibility. Will commits to an action or predicts an outcome; check whether that certainty is justified.

By versus at

By gives a latest time; at identifies a scheduled moment. State the time zone when people work across locations.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which sponsor update is accurate?

A Shared administrator access has been approved
B Login passed; invoice posting remains dependent on the legacy account
C All systems are integrated
D The scheduled window proves readiness

2. What should an acceptance check include here?

A Only whether the new logo appears
B Only an employee's successful password entry
C A green slide with no transaction evidence
D The invoice job's end-to-end result and reconciliation

3. Which response preserves control?

A Remove every approval because the schedule is tight
B Hide the dependency until after retirement
C Resolve access through the authorized least-privilege process
D Share one unrestricted administrator account

4. What is the status of the go-live decision?

A Delegated to every employee
B Not supplied as approved
C Automatically approved by the calendar
D Completed by the login test alone

Answers and explanations: page 93.

Successful login does not prove invoice posting works

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

least privilege / rollback plan / service account / go/no-go decision / User acceptance testing / data integrity / reconciliation / single sign-on / end-to-end test / legacy dependency

01 **Eric:** Employee login passed on the new platform. Can we tell the sponsor that the old identity service is ready to retire?

02 **Fatima:** Not yet. That [1] _____ test covers employee access, not every automated job using the existing environment.

03 **Eric:** The finance workstream mentioned that invoice posting runs on a schedule rather than through a person signing in.

04 **Fatima:** Correct. It still uses a legacy [2] _____, and that dependency has not been resolved in the new setup.

05 **Eric:** If we retire the old identity service before addressing it, the business impact could be failed invoice posting.

06 **Fatima:** That is the [3] _____ the sponsor needs to understand in operational terms.

07 **Eric:** We need to test the actual invoice process from its start through the expected output, not just repeat the login test.

08 **Fatima:** Yes. The [4] _____ must use the agreed requirements and authorized test arrangements.

09 **Eric:** Finance also needs to verify that the resulting records match the expected transactions and totals.

10 **Fatima:** Include that [5] _____ in the acceptance evidence. A job reporting success does not by itself prove that every output is correct.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

11 **Eric:** Someone suggested sharing a broad administrator account until the integration team has more time to solve the issue.

12 **Fatima:** That is not approved. Maintain [6] _____ and use the actual access-review process for an appropriate solution.

13 **Eric:** The cutover window is already in the calendar, but the remaining tests and approvals have not been completed.

14 **Fatima:** Then the [7] _____ remains separate from the scheduled window. We must report the unresolved facts before that review.

15 **Eric:** We should also know what happens if the approved transition starts and the business checks fail.

16 **Fatima:** The [8] _____ needs its actual owner, conditions, and verified feasibility rather than a vague promise to undo everything.

17 **Eric:** I will align the IT and finance updates so one does not say complete while the other still reports an untested process.

18 **Fatima:** Good. [9] _____ should reflect the business outcome, not just a successful technical component.

19 **Eric:** The sponsor update will state that login passed, invoice posting remains dependent on the old service, and the decision is pending.

20 **Fatima:** That makes [10] _____ and continuity visible without bypassing controls, inventing approval, or treating the new platform's appearance as evidence that the migration is complete.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. single sign-on | 2. service account | 3. legacy dependency | 4. end-to-end test | 5. reconciliation | 6. least privilege | 7. go/no-go decision | 8. rollback plan | 9. User acceptance testing | 10. data integrity

A successful job produced mismatched totals

F Say it

A test job reports success, but finance finds that its output total does not match the expected test transactions. No acceptance signoff has been given.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

reconcile / confirmed / decision / success

IT: "The job reported [1] _____."

Finance: "The totals do not [2] _____."

IT: "Business acceptance is not yet [3] _____."

Finance: "Record the discrepancy before the go/no-go [4] _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. success | 2. reconcile | 3. confirmed | 4. decision

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected exchange and explain the service-account dependency in ordinary business language.

2. Switch roles and state the unresolved test, control requirement, and go/no-go status.

3. Complete the four-line follow-up with the supplied choices. Check the explanations, then read the corrected exchange twice, changing roles.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

New ownership does not rewrite every invoice instruction

A Read the situation

Explain continuity to a customer while separating branding, contracting identity, and verified payment instructions.

After the acquisition, customer contact Morgan receives a new logo announcement and a separate email asking for payment to a new bank account. Under the supplied approved transition plan, the existing US subsidiary remains the invoicing entity and payment instructions have not been changed. Account lead Sofia and integration consultant Daniel must verify the unexpected email through established channels and avoid sending unapproved new instructions.

PEOPLE / Sofia: Account lead | Daniel: Integration consultant

REASSURANCE NEEDS SPECIFIC FACTS

Customers want to know whom they are dealing with, where to obtain support, and whether anything changes in the current process. A general welcome message should not imply unapproved contractual or payment changes.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which entity remains the invoicing entity under the supplied plan?

A The integration consultant
B The existing US subsidiary
C The overseas parent automatically
D A new unnamed company

2. What is the approved payment-instruction status?

A The new email is automatically valid
B Every invoice must use a new account
C The customer must choose between accounts
D No change has been approved

3. How should the unexpected email be treated?

A As proof that acquisition requires new bank details
B As harmless because it contains the logo
C As a completed authorized change
D As an unverified request needing established-channel verification

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

customer continuity

Maintenance of customer service and obligations during transition.

IN USE protect customer continuity

contracting entity

Legal person entering the relevant customer agreement.

IN USE identify the contracting entity

invoicing entity

Entity issuing the invoice under the actual arrangement.

IN USE confirm the invoicing entity

brand transition

Change in external name or visual presentation.

IN USE coordinate the brand transition

contract assignment

Transfer of contractual rights under the applicable terms and law.

IN USE review contract-assignment requirements

novation

Substitution of a contractual party or obligation under the applicable agreement and law.

IN USE obtain novation advice

customer consent

Customer agreement where required for a specified change.

IN USE verify customer-consent requirements

remittance instruction

Direction for making a payment.

IN USE verify remittance instructions

vendor master

Customer or company record containing supplier details.

IN USE control vendor-master changes

independent verification

Check using a trusted source separate from the unverified request.

IN USE perform independent verification

business email compromise

Fraud involving deceptive business communications or compromised accounts.

IN USE recognize business-email-compromise risk

callback control

Verification through an independently established contact route.

IN USE use the callback control

Precision check

The supplied plan retains the US invoicing entity and existing payment instructions. A new logo and an unexpected email do not authorize a bank-account change.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

service-level commitment

Stated obligation concerning the level of service.

IN USE preserve service-level commitments

account handoff

Transfer of customer relationship responsibilities.

IN USE coordinate the account handoff

customer-facing notice

Communication intended for customers.

IN USE approve customer-facing notices

authorized signatory

Person with the relevant power to sign or authorize an action.

IN USE verify the authorized signatory

commercial continuity plan

Approved arrangement for maintaining customer-facing operations.

IN USE follow the commercial continuity plan

payment redirection

Change to the destination or process for a payment.

IN USE investigate payment redirection

clarification request

Question that resolves an unclear meaning or instruction.

IN USE make a targeted clarification request

source attribution

Identification of where information came from.

IN USE preserve source attribution

working assumption

Provisional premise used while information is incomplete.

IN USE challenge a working assumption

scope boundary

Limit of the work or authority being discussed.

IN USE state the scope boundary

action owner

Named person responsible for a specified next step.

IN USE confirm the action owner

check-back

Restatement used to verify that a message was understood.

IN USE complete a check-back

Precision check

Real contract transfers, customer consents, tax invoices, and payment changes require their actual legal and control processes. The example does not establish universal acquisition consequences.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

SEPARATE IDENTITY AND BRANDING

"The logo changed; the approved invoicing entity has not."

CHALLENGE THE REQUEST

"That account-change email has not been verified."

AVOID EMAIL-LOOP VERIFICATION

"Do not rely only on the phone number inside the unverified message."

KEEP NOTICES CONSISTENT

"Customer-facing messages need the approved facts and review."

STATE CONTINUITY

"Continue using the existing approved payment instructions."

USE A TRUSTED ROUTE

"Confirm through contact details already independently established."

CLARIFY CONTRACT STATUS

"Ownership change alone does not answer the contract-transfer question."

CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"Confirm the account owner, support route, and any actually authorized changes."

Acquired by versus replaced by

Acquired by describes ownership; replaced by describes substitution and should not be assumed for the contracting entity.

Verified through versus replied to

Verification requires a reliable independent basis; replying to the same unverified sender is not equivalent.

No approved change versus no possible change

The first reports the current plan; the second makes an unsupported claim about every future arrangement.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CLARIFY THE QUESTION

"Are you asking about the finding or the next step?"

INVITE CORRECTION

"Please correct me if I have misunderstood that detail."

ATTRIBUTE INFORMATION

"That is what the current record says; it has not been independently confirmed."

SEPARATE POSSIBILITY

"That is a possibility, not an agreed outcome."

CHECK SCOPE

"That decision sits outside my authority."

PIN DOWN RESPONSIBILITY

"Who is responsible for that specific next step?"

REPAIR MISUNDERSTANDING

"Let me restate the distinction more clearly."

CLOSE AN EXCHANGE

"We agree on the action, the owner, and the point for review."

Reported versus verified

Reported attributes information to a source; verified indicates it has been checked. Do not use the words interchangeably.

Could versus will

Could introduces a possibility. Will commits to an action or predicts an outcome; check whether that certainty is justified.

By versus at

By gives a latest time; at identifies a scheduled moment. State the time zone when people work across locations.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which customer statement matches the approved plan?

A The existing US entity and payment instructions remain in use
B The parent automatically replaces every contract party
C The new logo validates the new bank account
D The customer should pay whichever email arrived latest

2. Which verification route is appropriate?

A The appearance of the company logo
B Independently established trusted contact details
C Only the number in the unexpected email
D A reply asking the same sender to confirm itself

3. What must be reviewed separately from branding?

A Actual contract and invoicing-entity changes
B Whether the logo file opens
C The color of a presentation title
D The alphabetical order of contacts

4. What should the team avoid?

A Explaining the current approved plan
B Coordinating with the authorized account owner
C Sending unapproved replacement payment instructions
D Preserving the unexpected message through the reporting process

Answers and explanations: page 95.

New ownership does not rewrite every invoice instruction

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Payment redirection / business email compromise / customer continuity / brand transition / contracting entity / vendor master / invoicing entity / customer-facing notice / independent verification / commercial continuity plan

01 **Sofia:** A customer received our new logo announcement and then an email asking them to pay a different bank account. They assume both are part of integration.

02 **Daniel:** Separate the [1] _____ from the payment request. The approved plan has not changed the remittance instructions.

03 **Sofia:** The customer also asks whether the overseas parent now replaces the US subsidiary on every invoice.

04 **Daniel:** Under the approved plan, the [2] _____ remains the existing US subsidiary. We should not infer a substitution from the acquisition announcement.

05 **Sofia:** Their contract names that subsidiary too, but any actual transfer question needs the appropriate legal review.

06 **Daniel:** Correct. The [3] _____ and its obligations should be described from the actual records, not a simplified group label.

07 **Sofia:** For the bank-account email, we should verify through the contact route already established in the relationship.

08 **Daniel:** Yes. Use [4] _____ rather than relying on a new phone number printed in that same email.

09 **Sofia:** I will not send a replacement account number or ask the customer to choose between the two sets of instructions.

10 **Daniel:** Good. [5] _____ needs the actual controlled process and verified authorization.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

11 **Sofia:** The logo and correct account-manager name make the email look convincing, but those details do not establish that it is genuine.

12 **Daniel:** That is why [6] _____ is relevant during a transition. A plausible integration story should not bypass the controls.

13 **Sofia:** The customer may also need to update its supplier record, but we should give only approved entity information.

14 **Daniel:** Exactly. Any [7] _____ change should follow the customer's and our actual verification requirements.

15 **Sofia:** Our immediate response can explain that the existing approved payment instructions remain in place while the unexpected request is checked.

16 **Daniel:** That protects [8] _____ without pretending that every integration question is already resolved.

17 **Sofia:** I will coordinate the account response with finance and the authorized security or fraud-reporting contact, preserving the message as required.

18 **Daniel:** Also align the [9] _____ so customers do not receive conflicting instructions from sales, finance, and the integration team.

19 **Sofia:** The account owner and support route remain clear, and any future approved change will use the actual notice and verification process.

20 **Daniel:** Record that in the [10] _____. New ownership is not a reason to improvise a contract transfer or a bank-account change.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. brand transition | 2. invoicing entity | 3. contracting entity | 4. independent verification | 5. Payment redirection | 6. business email compromise | 7. vendor master | 8. customer continuity | 9. customer-facing notice | 10. commercial continuity plan

A reply was treated as independent verification

F Say it

A team replies to an unexpected bank-account-change email, and the same sender says it is genuine. No independently verified contact has confirmed the request.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

verification / contact / unverified / sender

Lead: "The reply came from the same [1] _____."

Consultant: "That is not independent [2] _____."

Lead: "We need an established trusted [3] _____."

Consultant: "The payment change remains [4] _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. sender | 2. verification | 3. contact | 4. unverified

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected exchange and distinguish brand, contracting entity, invoicing entity, and payment destination.

2. Switch roles and give the customer the current approved status without supplying new payment details.

3. Complete the four-line follow-up with the supplied choices. Check the explanations, then read the corrected exchange twice, changing roles.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Annual run rate is not money already realized

A Read the situation

Reconcile annualized savings, realized results, and integration costs on a defined reporting basis.

A fictional procurement change saves USD 50,000 per month for three completed months against the agreed baseline. Gross realized savings are USD 150,000. A one-time integration cost of USD 90,000 belongs to the same reporting period and defined cash basis, giving USD 60,000 net realized benefit. Annualizing the monthly saving gives a USD 600,000 run rate, not a realized full-year result. IT and procurement both list the same saving in their workstream reports.

PEOPLE / Nina: Integration finance lead | Oscar: Procurement lead

MAKE A DEFENSIBLE RESULT VISIBLE

A smaller, correctly labeled realized benefit is more useful than an inflated headline. Shared contributions can be acknowledged without booking the same saving twice.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the gross realized saving for the three months?

A USD 60,000
B USD 90,000
C USD 150,000
D USD 600,000

2. What is the net realized benefit on the supplied basis?

A USD 510,000
B USD 60,000
C USD 150,000
D USD 600,000

3. Why must the two workstream reports be reconciled?

A Monthly and annual units are always identical
B They list the same saving
C Each has a different verified benefit
D The saving has no owner

Answers and explanations: page 97.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

synergy

Benefit attributed to combining businesses under a defined analysis.

IN USE substantiate the synergy

baseline

Agreed reference against which a change is measured.

IN USE establish the savings baseline

gross saving

Benefit before the specified related costs.

IN USE report the gross saving

net benefit

Benefit after the specified costs on the defined basis.

IN USE reconcile the net benefit

run-rate saving

Annualized or other normalized saving based on a stated current rate.

IN USE distinguish run-rate savings

in-period realization

Benefit actually achieved within the stated reporting period.

IN USE verify in-period realization

one-time integration cost

Nonrecurring transition cost under the stated classification.

IN USE track one-time integration costs

benefit owner

Person accountable for delivering and substantiating a benefit.

IN USE name the benefit owner

realization date

Date from which a benefit is treated as achieved under the methodology.

IN USE verify the realization date

benefit register

Record of benefits, owners, assumptions, and status.

IN USE update the benefit register

cost avoidance

Prevention of a prospective cost rather than necessarily reducing an existing expense.

IN USE distinguish cost avoidance

headcount saving

Defined labor-cost reduction subject to actual staffing and cost effects.

IN USE validate headcount savings

Precision check

50,000 x 3 = 150,000 gross realized; 150,000 - 90,000 = 60,000 net realized. 50,000 x 12 = 600,000 annualized run rate, not a completed-year saving.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

procurement saving

Reduction attributed to purchasing changes on a specified basis.

IN USE verify procurement savings

revenue synergy

Additional revenue attributed to integration under a defined analysis.

IN USE assess revenue synergies

dis-synergy

Adverse cost or revenue effect associated with integration.

IN USE identify dis-synergies

double counting

Recording the same underlying benefit more than once.

IN USE prevent double counting

finance validation

Review of figures and methodology by the designated finance role.

IN USE obtain finance validation

benefit bridge

Reconciliation from baseline and gross effects to the reported benefit.

IN USE prepare the benefit bridge

clarification request

Question that resolves an unclear meaning or instruction.

IN USE make a targeted clarification request

source attribution

Identification of where information came from.

IN USE preserve source attribution

working assumption

Provisional premise used while information is incomplete.

IN USE challenge a working assumption

scope boundary

Limit of the work or authority being discussed.

IN USE state the scope boundary

action owner

Named person responsible for a specified next step.

IN USE confirm the action owner

check-back

Restatement used to verify that a message was understood.

IN USE complete a check-back

Precision check

All figures use the supplied reporting period and cash basis. Real accounting recognition, attribution, timing, and future sustainability require the actual methodology and review.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

LABEL THE MEASURE

"Six hundred thousand is the annualized run rate."

STATE REALIZATION

"The completed three-month gross saving is one hundred fifty thousand."

INCLUDE THE COST

"The same-period integration cost reduces net realized benefit to sixty thousand."

PREVENT DUPLICATION

"IT and procurement contributed to one saving, not two separate benefits."

CHECK THE BASELINE

"Which agreed reference supports this calculation?"

SEPARATE FUTURE AND PAST

"The run rate assumes the monthly level continues."

NAME ACCOUNTABILITY

"One benefit owner should coordinate the supporting evidence."

REPORT THE BRIDGE

"Show baseline, gross realization, included costs, and net result together."

Annualized versus realized

Annualized projects a rate over a year; realized identifies benefit achieved in the stated period.

Avoided versus saved

Avoided can refer to a cost that did not arise; saved needs the actual baseline and measurement to be clear.

Contributed to versus owns the total

Several workstreams can contribute to one benefit without each recording the full amount as separate value.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CLARIFY THE QUESTION

"Are you asking about the finding or the next step?"

INVITE CORRECTION

"Please correct me if I have misunderstood that detail."

ATTRIBUTE INFORMATION

"That is what the current record says; it has not been independently confirmed."

SEPARATE POSSIBILITY

"That is a possibility, not an agreed outcome."

CHECK SCOPE

"That decision sits outside my authority."

PIN DOWN RESPONSIBILITY

"Who is responsible for that specific next step?"

REPAIR MISUNDERSTANDING

"Let me restate the distinction more clearly."

CLOSE AN EXCHANGE

"We agree on the action, the owner, and the point for review."

Reported versus verified

Reported attributes information to a source; verified indicates it has been checked. Do not use the words interchangeably.

Could versus will

Could introduces a possibility. Will commits to an action or predicts an outcome; check whether that certainty is justified.

By versus at

By gives a latest time; at identifies a scheduled moment. State the time zone when people work across locations.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which headline is accurate?

A 600,000 already realized in three months
B 150,000 net after the 90,000 cost
C 1.2 million because two workstreams reported the saving
D 600,000 annualized run rate; 60,000 net realized in the stated period

2. What is the double-counting correction?

A Add both reports because both teams worked on it
B Remove the cost so the numbers match
C Call the same saving a second revenue synergy
D Record the underlying benefit once while acknowledging both teams

3. Which item is needed to interpret savings?

A A count of how many teams attended meetings
B The agreed baseline and reporting basis
C Only a larger headline figure
D A promise that all future months are identical

4. What does the annual run rate assume?

A That twelve months have already elapsed
B That no future risk can change the saving
C That integration costs never exist
D Continuation of the stated monthly rate for annualization

Answers and explanations: page 97.

Annual run rate is not money already realized

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

benefit register / benefit bridge / double counting / finance validation / run-rate saving / net benefit / baseline / one-time integration cost / in-period realization / Cost avoidance

01 **Oscar:** The procurement change saves fifty thousand dollars a month, so I reported six hundred thousand as realized integration savings.

02 **Nina:** That is the annualized [1] _____, not the completed-period result. We have three months of actual savings in the supplied record.

03 **Oscar:** Three times fifty thousand gives one hundred fifty thousand of gross savings for those completed months.

04 **Nina:** Correct. That is the [2] _____ before the related cost included in this reporting basis.

05 **Oscar:** The one-time implementation expense was ninety thousand in the same period, and the report uses the stated cash basis.

06 **Nina:** Then include the [3] _____ rather than letting the headline imply the change was free to deliver.

07 **Oscar:** The net realized benefit is therefore sixty thousand, even though the monthly saving could continue beyond this quarter.

08 **Nina:** Exactly. The [4] _____ and the annual run rate are useful but different measures.

09 **Oscar:** I also noticed that IT listed the same vendor reduction in its workstream total because it helped remove duplicate licenses.

10 **Nina:** We need to prevent [5] _____. Acknowledging both teams does not create two separate economic benefits.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

11 **Oscar:** We can assign one shared record to the saving and show IT and procurement as contributors.

12 **Nina:** Put that in the [6] _____, with a single accountable owner for assembling and validating the evidence.

13 **Oscar:** We should also identify the reference cost we compared against, so the saving is not based on an unexplained estimate.

14 **Nina:** Yes. The agreed [7] _____ and any adjustments need to be traceable rather than reconstructed after the result is announced.

15 **Oscar:** If a planned future expense never occurs, should we record that in the same way as this reduction in an existing cost?

16 **Nina:** Not automatically. [8] _____ needs its own definition and evidence under the reporting methodology.

17 **Oscar:** I will show the monthly rate, actual months, gross amount, included cost, and net result in the steering pack.

18 **Nina:** That creates a clear [9] _____, with the six-hundred-thousand annualization labeled separately.

19 **Oscar:** The revised headline will acknowledge the ongoing opportunity without saying that a full year's saving has already been achieved.

20 **Nina:** Good. Complete the required [10] _____ and retain the evidence, so the report is credible rather than merely larger.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. run-rate saving | 2. in-period realization | 3. one-time integration cost | 4. net benefit | 5. double counting | 6. benefit register | 7. baseline | 8. Cost avoidance | 9. benefit bridge | 10. finance validation

A forecast entered the realized column

F Say it

A future supplier change is forecast to save USD 20,000 monthly after approval. Approval and implementation have not occurred, and no saving has been realized.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

forecast / total / outstanding / realized

Lead: "The amount is currently a [1] _____."

Finance: "The required approval remains [2] _____."

Lead: "No benefit has been [3] _____."

Finance: "Keep it out of the realized-benefit [4] _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. forecast | 2. outstanding | 3. realized | 4. total

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected exchange and state the gross, cost, net, and annualized figures with their periods.

2. Switch roles and explain how two teams can contribute without creating two separately counted savings.

3. Complete the four-line follow-up with the supplied choices. Check the explanations, then read the corrected exchange twice, changing roles.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

An assigned issue is not a resolved issue

A Read the situation

Confirm acceptance evidence, ongoing support, and residual-risk ownership before closing integration work.

The fictional handover plan requires five consecutive stable operating days before service acceptance. The new process has completed two stable days. A reporting defect remains open but has an identified finance owner. Sponsor Morgan wants the integration workstream closed immediately. Consultant Arjun explains the unmet acceptance condition and prepares the operational ownership, support, and open-item records without claiming that assignment means resolution.

PEOPLE / Morgan: Integration sponsor | Arjun: Integration consultant

A CLEAR HANDOVER PROTECTS BOTH TEAMS

An integration team should not disappear behind a green status. The receiving operation needs evidence, workable support, and explicit ownership of remaining work.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many stable days are required by this fictional plan?

A Five consecutive days
B Two days
C Any single successful login
D An unspecified month

2. What is the reporting defect's status?

A Open with a named finance owner
B Resolved because someone owns it
C Deleted from the record
D Accepted as proof that every process is stable

3. Why is immediate acceptance unsupported?

A The transaction never closed
B Every support contact is forbidden
C The process has no owner at all
D Only two of the required five stable days are complete

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

business as usual

Ongoing operational work after the temporary integration phase.

IN USE transition to business as usual

acceptance criteria

Conditions that must be met for the stated acceptance decision.

IN USE verify acceptance criteria

service acceptance

Formal acceptance of an operational service under the actual process.

IN USE obtain service acceptance

operational signoff

Authorized confirmation of operational readiness or acceptance.

IN USE secure operational signoff

knowledge transfer

Handover of information and practical capability to another team.

IN USE complete knowledge transfer

runbook

Operational instructions and responsibilities for recurring tasks or incidents.

IN USE validate the runbook

standard operating procedure

Approved instructions for a defined recurring process.

IN USE update the standard operating procedure

open risk

Identified unresolved uncertainty or exposure.

IN USE retain an open risk

defect backlog

Record of unresolved defects and their status.

IN USE maintain the defect backlog

incident owner

Person responsible for handling a specified operational incident.

IN USE name the incident owner

support coverage

Availability and scope of assistance during stated periods.

IN USE confirm support coverage

monitoring cadence

Frequency of reviewing operational indicators or issues.

IN USE agree the monitoring cadence

Precision check

Two stable days do not satisfy the supplied five-consecutive-day criterion. An open defect remains open when an owner is assigned.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

escalation contact

Named route for raising an issue requiring further authority or support.

IN USE verify the escalation contact

operating budget

Resources allocated for ongoing operations.

IN USE confirm the operating budget

ownership transfer

Explicit handover of responsibility to the receiving role.

IN USE document ownership transfer

transition exit

Completion of the defined temporary transition arrangement.

IN USE approve transition exit

closure report

Record of completed scope, outstanding matters, and closure authority.

IN USE prepare the closure report

post-integration review

Evaluation of integration results and remaining lessons after the transition.

IN USE schedule a post-integration review

clarification request

Question that resolves an unclear meaning or instruction.

IN USE make a targeted clarification request

source attribution

Identification of where information came from.

IN USE preserve source attribution

working assumption

Provisional premise used while information is incomplete.

IN USE challenge a working assumption

scope boundary

Limit of the work or authority being discussed.

IN USE state the scope boundary

action owner

Named person responsible for a specified next step.

IN USE confirm the action owner

check-back

Restatement used to verify that a message was understood.

IN USE complete a check-back

Precision check

Actual acceptance, exception authority, and closure processes depend on the program. Do not silently waive criteria or transfer risk without the required agreement and records.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CHECK THE CRITERION

"We have completed two stable days against a five-day requirement."

SEPARATE ASSIGNMENT AND RESOLUTION

"Finance owns the defect, but the defect is still open."

CONFIRM THE RECEIVER

"Who accepts the ongoing operational responsibility?"

MAKE SUPPORT USABLE

"The receiving team needs the runbook and actual escalation contacts."

PRESERVE THE RECORD

"Open items must remain visible after the project label changes."

CLARIFY AUTHORITY

"Any exception needs the stated approval; it cannot be implied by a target date."

AVOID A FALSE CLOSE

"We can prepare the handover without declaring acceptance complete."

CLOSE DELIBERATELY

"Record completed scope, remaining obligations, and the authorized closure decision."

Assigned versus resolved

Assigned names responsibility; resolved claims the underlying issue has been addressed.

Prepared versus accepted

Prepared describes readiness of the handover materials; accepted describes the actual receiving decision.

Consecutive versus total

Consecutive requires an uninterrupted sequence; five scattered stable days may not meet that stated condition.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CLARIFY THE QUESTION

"Are you asking about the finding or the next step?"

INVITE CORRECTION

"Please correct me if I have misunderstood that detail."

ATTRIBUTE INFORMATION

"That is what the current record says; it has not been independently confirmed."

SEPARATE POSSIBILITY

"That is a possibility, not an agreed outcome."

CHECK SCOPE

"That decision sits outside my authority."

PIN DOWN RESPONSIBILITY

"Who is responsible for that specific next step?"

REPAIR MISUNDERSTANDING

"Let me restate the distinction more clearly."

CLOSE AN EXCHANGE

"We agree on the action, the owner, and the point for review."

Reported versus verified

Reported attributes information to a source; verified indicates it has been checked. Do not use the words interchangeably.

Could versus will

Could introduces a possibility. Will commits to an action or predicts an outcome; check whether that certainty is justified.

By versus at

By gives a latest time; at identifies a scheduled moment. State the time zone when people work across locations.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which status report is accurate?

A The defect is resolved because finance owns it
B Every open item disappears at handover
C Two stable days complete; acceptance condition unmet
D Five stable days complete because the sponsor wants closure

2. What should happen to the defect at handover?

A Retain its status, owner, next action, and review route
B Remove it because the project is ending
C Mark it closed without evidence
D Transfer it to an unnamed department

3. What should knowledge transfer establish?

A A promise that no incident can occur
B The receiving team's practical ability to operate the process
C Only that a file was emailed
D Only a new organization chart

4. What is required for an exception to the criterion?

A A green status color
B The consultant's wish to finish
C The actual specified exception authority and process
D An implied waiver from schedule pressure

Answers and explanations: page 99.

An assigned issue is not a resolved issue

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

knowledge transfer / closure report / open risk / defect backlog / runbook / Support coverage / acceptance criteria / service acceptance / Ownership transfer / post-integration review

01 **Morgan:** The process has worked for two days, and finance owns the remaining reporting issue. Can we close the workstream today?

02 **Arjun:** The [1] _____ specify five consecutive stable days. We have completed two, not the required five.

03 **Morgan:** I do not want the integration team to remain indefinitely just because one minor report still needs attention.

04 **Arjun:** We can plan the handover, but [2] _____ and closure need their actual evidence and authority.

05 **Morgan:** The finance lead has accepted responsibility for the report. Does that at least mean we can mark the defect closed?

06 **Arjun:** No. The [3] _____ should show it as open with an owner, next action, and review route.

07 **Morgan:** The receiving team also needs to know how the new process works and whom to contact when something fails.

08 **Arjun:** That is [4] _____, not just a document email. We need to check that the operational team can use the material.

09 **Morgan:** We have a draft procedure, but the escalation contact still points to a consultant who leaves next week.

10 **Arjun:** Then the [5] _____ needs a workable ongoing contact before we describe the support arrangement as complete.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

11 **Morgan:** We should confirm the hours and scope of support instead of assuming the receiving team provides the same transition coverage.

12 **Arjun:** Yes. [6] _____ and the operating resources need explicit agreement.

13 **Morgan:** Could we say the handover is prepared while leaving acceptance pending until the stated conditions are met?

14 **Arjun:** That is accurate. [7] _____ still needs the receiving role's actual acceptance and the required record.

15 **Morgan:** If leadership wants an exception to the five-day condition, it should be a visible decision through the specified authority.

16 **Arjun:** Correct. Do not hide an [8] _____ by changing the status label. Any exception needs its actual approval and conditions.

17 **Morgan:** I will tell the sponsor group that handover preparation is progressing, but the operating evidence does not yet meet the criterion.

18 **Arjun:** Include that distinction in the [9] _____, along with the reporting defect and the named operational responsibilities.

19 **Morgan:** After acceptance, we should review whether the integration achieved its intended service and value outcomes, not just whether the project ended.

20 **Arjun:** Schedule the [10] _____. That keeps attention on the ongoing business result without declaring unfinished work complete today.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. acceptance criteria | 2. service acceptance | 3. defect backlog | 4. knowledge transfer | 5. runbook | 6. Support coverage | 7. Ownership transfer | 8. open risk | 9. closure report | 10. post-integration review

A file transfer was called knowledge transfer

F Say it

The consultant emails the runbook. The receiving team has not reviewed it, confirmed the contacts, or accepted responsibility.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

transfer / accepted / sent / pending

Consultant: "The document has been [1] _____."

Operator: "Our practical review is still [2] _____."

Consultant: "Responsibility has not been formally [3] _____."

Operator: "We need a usable handover, not only a file [4] _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. sent | 2. pending | 3. accepted | 4. transfer

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected exchange and distinguish assigned, prepared, accepted, and resolved.

2. Switch roles and give the handover status using the two completed days, five-day criterion, and open reporting defect.

3. Complete the four-line follow-up with the supplied choices. Check the explanations, then read the corrected exchange twice, changing roles.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A requested extension does not keep a transition service running

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Separate a contractual service window, a requested extension, and tested replacement capability.

The fictional transition service agreement provides seller-operated reporting support through Friday at 18:00 New York local time. The buyer has requested an extension, but none has been agreed. A replacement report can be generated but its totals have not been reconciled. No unapproved work-around, continued seller access, or extension is authorized.

PEOPLE / Maya: Integration consultant | Eric: Receiving finance lead

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

continuity risk / service boundary / transition plan / exit criteria / extension request / standalone capability

01 **Maya:** The seller provides reporting support until Friday at six in the evening, New York time. Can your team operate independently after that?

02 **Eric:** We can generate the replacement report, but its totals have not been reconciled against the approved source.

03 **Maya:** Then generation alone does not establish [1] _____. We need to distinguish a working screen from an accepted business result.

04 **Eric:** I requested another week of support. The seller acknowledged receiving the request, so I thought we had extra time.

05 **Maya:** Receipt is not agreement to the [2] _____. The current end time remains the planning constraint.

06 **Eric:** I will correct the tracker. It currently says extended, which makes the replacement work look less urgent than it is.

07 **Maya:** Good. The [3] _____ also matters. More time, if agreed, would not automatically include extra tasks.

08 **Eric:** We need the authorized owners to review any changed scope, cost, access, and support arrangements with the seller.

09 **Maya:** Yes. Meanwhile, what evidence is still missing from the replacement report, and who can verify it?

10 **Eric:** The finance owner needs the totals reconciled and the discrepancies explained. We have not completed that review.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

11 **Maya:** Record those [4] _____ explicitly so the exit decision is based on the actual receiving process.

12 **Eric:** The timing is tight, but I should not certify the totals or presume continued seller access just to make the dashboard green.

13 **Maya:** Correct. Raise the [5] _____ with the decision owner while the current service is still available.

14 **Eric:** I can supply the remaining checks, their owners, and the impact if the service ends before the replacement is accepted.

15 **Maya:** That makes the escalation actionable. Keep the current contract status separate from any option being discussed.

16 **Eric:** If the parties agree an extension, the confirmed terms need to reach the receiving team before anyone changes the plan.

17 **Maya:** Exactly. Update the [6] _____ from the authorized decision and preserve the earlier status.

18 **Eric:** For now, I will report the Friday end time, the unagreed extension request, and the unresolved reconciliation.

19 **Maya:** That is a clear account of what works, what expires, and what still needs a decision.

20 **Eric:** I will also name the next update time so neither team assumes the other is silently handling the gap.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. standalone capability | 2. extension request | 3. service boundary | 4. exit criteria | 5. continuity risk | 6. transition plan

Acknowledged was changed to agreed

F Say it in a new situation

The seller acknowledges an extension request but has not agreed to extend support. The original service end time still applies.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

time / risk / acknowledged / agreed

Consultant: "The request was [1] _____."

Lead: "An extension has not been [2] _____."

Consultant: "Keep the original end [3] _____ visible."

Lead: "Escalate the continuity [4] _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. acknowledged | 2. agreed | 3. time | 4. risk

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.

2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.

3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

One handoff instant appears on two calendar dates

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Read back a cross-border handoff using a date, time, and explicit UTC offset.

For this fictional exercise only, the agreed handoff is 23:00 on 14 November at UTC-05:00, which is 13:00 on 15 November at UTC+09:00. Those explicit offsets define the conversion; no inference about a city's seasonal clock rules is needed. The tracker says November 14 without a time or zone. The receiving lead has not accepted the handoff.

PEOPLE / Noah: US workstream lead | Yuki: Receiving integration lead

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

UTC+09:00 / timestamp / change notice / UTC-05:00 / acceptance / handoff window

01 **Noah:** The tracker says November fourteenth, but your calendar says the fifteenth. I assumed one of us had moved the handoff.

02 **Yuki:** We may be describing the same instant on different local dates. Let us read back the complete timestamp before changing anything.

03 **Noah:** Our agreed time is twenty-three hundred on November fourteenth at [1] _____. That is the offset written in the handoff plan.

04 **Yuki:** For my calendar, the same instant is thirteen hundred on November fifteenth at [2] _____. The dates differ, but the event has not moved.

05 **Noah:** Then the short date label loses information we need. It could send someone to the bridge on the wrong day.

06 **Yuki:** Exactly. Preserve the [3] _____ with its date, time, and offset instead of relying on an unexplained local date.

07 **Noah:** The numeric version of the date also needs care because teams may read the month and day in different orders.

08 **Yuki:** Use the agreed unambiguous format and read it back. Do not infer that everyone interprets a short numeric date the same way.

09 **Noah:** I will update the meeting invitation and tracker together so we do not leave conflicting versions in circulation.

10 **Yuki:** Good. Include the source system and the planned [4] _____ rather than only the meeting title.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

11 **Noah:** We also need to check whether the receiving person can attend at that actual local time, not just whether the invitation was sent.

12 **Yuki:** Yes. A sent invitation is not my [5] _____ of the operational handoff.

13 **Noah:** The reporting pack is ready to share, but I will keep the receiving acceptance open until you confirm the required checks.

14 **Yuki:** That is appropriate. The correct timestamp solves the scheduling ambiguity, not the readiness or responsibility questions.

15 **Noah:** If the agreed event time changes, we should update both representations from one authoritative source.

16 **Yuki:** And record the [6] _____ so nobody mistakes a formatting correction for a new operational deadline.

17 **Noah:** For this correction, the instant remains unchanged: November fourteenth at twenty-three hundred with the minus-five offset.

18 **Yuki:** Which is November fifteenth at thirteen hundred with the plus-nine offset. I will confirm availability separately from operational acceptance.

19 **Noah:** I will send the corrected record with the open acceptance item and the responsible owner.

20 **Yuki:** Good. The teams will share one event and one status, even though their calendars display different dates.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. UTC-05:00 | 2. UTC+09:00 | 3. timestamp | 4. handoff window | 5. acceptance | 6. change notice

Same instant, different local date

F Say it in a new situation

Use only these supplied equivalents: 23:00 on 14 November at UTC-05:00 equals 13:00 on 15 November at UTC+09:00.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

fourteenth / unchanged / offset / fifteenth

US lead: "Our local date is November [1] _____."

Receiving lead: "Our local date is November [2] _____."

US lead: "The underlying instant is [3] _____."

Receiving lead: "Always include the UTC [4] _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. fourteenth | 2. fifteenth | 3. unchanged | 4. offset

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.

2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.

3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Two green delivery dashboards measure different events

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Reconcile metric definitions before combining acquired and acquiring company performance.

The acquired company labels an order on time when it leaves the warehouse by the promised dispatch time. The buyer labels it on time when it reaches the customer by the promised delivery time. In a fictional sample of 100 orders, 95 meet the dispatch promise and 82 meet the delivery promise. No common combined historical metric has yet been agreed.

PEOPLE / Consultant: Integration reporting lead | Operations: US operations analyst

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

data lineage / combined KPI / metric definition / denominator / common baseline / measurement specification

01 **Consultant:** Both dashboards say on-time delivery, but one reports ninety-five percent and the other reports eighty-two. Is one calculation wrong?

02 **Operations:** Not necessarily. The first checks whether the order left our warehouse on time; the second checks arrival at the customer.

03 **Consultant:** Then the [1] _____ differs even though the dashboard labels look identical.

04 **Operations:** Correct. In this sample, ninety-five of the hundred orders met the dispatch promise and eighty-two met the delivery promise.

05 **Consultant:** Both calculations use the same [2] _____, but they answer different operational questions.

06 **Operations:** We should not call the thirteen-percentage-point difference a decline after acquisition. We have not established a comparable before-and-after measure.

07 **Consultant:** Exactly. We need a [3] _____ before claiming that integration improved or damaged performance.

08 **Operations:** The source records may support both measures, but we need to check the event timestamps and the promise recorded for each order.

09 **Consultant:** Document that [4] _____ so the final number can be traced to the actual event and calculation.

10 **Operations:** Some orders have a dispatch timestamp but no verified customer-arrival record. That should remain a data gap, not an invented arrival.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

11 **Consultant:** Yes. Missing arrival evidence must not be silently converted into a pass or treated as proof of the actual delivery time.

12 **Operations:** We also need to agree how to handle cancellations and changed promises before combining later reporting periods.

13 **Consultant:** Put those rules in the [5] _____ with the owner who can approve the reporting definition.

14 **Operations:** Until that is agreed, the steering report can show dispatch performance and arrival performance separately with accurate labels.

15 **Consultant:** That will prevent a superficial standardization from producing a misleading [6] _____ for the acquired and acquiring businesses.

16 **Operations:** Should we average ninety-five and eighty-two and call that our overall delivery score?

17 **Consultant:** Not as a substitute for a defined measure. Those percentages describe different events, so their average would answer no agreed question.

18 **Operations:** I will relabel the current figures and prepare the definition differences for the process owners to decide.

19 **Consultant:** Good. Keep the original records intact so the team can reconstruct the reporting change.

20 **Operations:** Then the integration report can explain the current results honestly while the common measurement approach is being established.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. metric definition | 2. denominator | 3. common baseline | 4. data lineage | 5. measurement specification | 6. combined KPI

A dispatch result became an arrival promise

F Say it in a new situation

Of 100 orders, 95 meet the dispatch promise and 82 meet the arrival promise. The two events must remain separately labeled.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

decline / arrival / dispatch / different

Analyst: "Ninety-five percent met the [1] _____ promise."

Lead: "Eighty-two percent met the [2] _____ promise."

Analyst: "The event definitions are [3] _____."

Lead: "Do not infer an integration-related [4] _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. dispatch | 2. arrival | 3. different | 4. decline

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.

2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.

3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Protecting Day 1 business continuity

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What has been completed?

C. Legal acquisition closing
The transaction closed Friday, while the shared platform remains unready.

2. Which process continues under the supplied plan?

A. The existing approved payroll process
The brief explicitly retains the existing approved payroll process for continuity.

3. What should be separated from Monday continuity?

C. The later platform migration
The migration is later work with readiness and authorization still outstanding.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which Monday message is supported?

C. Payroll continues under the existing approved process
The brief explicitly retains the current payroll process while the new platform is unready.

2. Which question identifies continuity responsibility?

A. Who owns payroll operation during the transition?
A named operational owner is needed rather than an assumption from corporate ownership.

3. What should a readiness statement include?

D. The specific services and scope checked
Readiness has meaning only in relation to stated requirements and evidence.

4. Which action is not authorized by the case?

A. Migrating payroll immediately
The brief expressly says no immediate payroll migration is authorized.

01 Conversation answers

Protecting Day 1 business continuity

E Dialogue gaps 1-5

Pages 10-11

1. legal close. Turn 2. Legal close confirms the completed transaction but does not establish that operational systems and processes have been integrated.

2. Day 1 readiness. Turn 4. Day 1 readiness concerns the specified immediate operating requirements rather than completion of the entire future integration plan.

3. business continuity. Turn 6. Business continuity preserves required operations through the transition instead of making an unready migration a symbolic sign of progress.

4. interim operating model. Turn 8. The interim operating model is the deliberate temporary arrangement used while later integration prerequisites remain unresolved.

5. dependency. Turn 10. A dependency identifies a prerequisite for the later migration and prevents the task from being scheduled as though readiness already exists.

F Transfer answers 1-2

Page 12

1. changed

Employee: "The branding has changed."

The portal appearance has changed, but that does not establish a new operating process.

2. unchanged

Consultant: "The approved support route remains unchanged."

The brief explicitly retains the existing support process.

E Dialogue gaps 6-10

Pages 10-11

6. integration management office. Turn 12. The integration management office coordinates workstreams and governance but does not automatically replace every functional decision owner.

7. continuity owner. Turn 14. The continuity owner is the named person responsible for sustaining the specified service during transition, not an assumed responsibility of the buyer in general.

8. service desk. Turn 16. The service desk provides the user support route and needs accurate transition information rather than an overbroad claim that every system has changed.

9. readiness checkpoint. Turn 18. A readiness checkpoint reviews the stated prerequisites and evidence before the relevant transition rather than substituting a calendar date for readiness.

10. target operating model. Turn 20. The target operating model describes the intended future arrangement, which must remain distinct from the current interim state and completed Day 1 scope.

F Transfer answers 3-4

Page 12

3. launched

Employee: "The shared platform has not launched."

The new platform is not yet in operation in the supplied case.

4. process

Consultant: "Use the current approved process."

Employees should follow the actual operating arrangement rather than infer a change from branding.

02 Briefing and language checks

Clarifying integration decision rights

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What did the sponsor provide?

C. Support for the standardization concept
The brief identifies conceptual support, not the required completed decision steps.

2. Who coordinates but cannot approve the change?

C. Leo
Leo's stated role is coordination, without process-change approval authority.

3. Which sequence is required before implementation here?

D. Finance ownership, local legal consultation, and steering approval
The fictional decision matrix explicitly requires these roles and approval steps.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which response preserves momentum and governance?

D. Coordinate the required reviews and decision request
This choice advances the proposal while respecting the supplied approval route.

2. Which statement accurately describes Leo's role?

B. He coordinates the proposal without approving it
The case explicitly gives Leo coordination responsibility but not approval authority.

3. What belongs in a decision log?

A. Actual decision, authority, rationale, and conditions
A decision record needs the actual outcome and its limits rather than shorthand that invents authorization.

4. What should happen if a required decision is delayed?

B. Use the stated escalation path
Delay should be addressed through the agreed governance, not converted into permission.

02 Conversation answers

Clarifying integration decision rights

E Dialogue gaps 1-5

Pages 19-20

1. decision rights. Turn 2. Decision rights identify who can authorize the actual process change, which is not established solely by a sponsor's favorable reaction.

2. executive sponsor. Turn 4. The executive sponsor supports the initiative under the defined role but does not automatically override every specific approval route in the supplied governance.

3. process owner. Turn 6. The process owner has the defined accountability for the affected operation and must be involved rather than bypassed by a workstream preference.

4. consulted stakeholder. Turn 8. A consulted stakeholder supplies the specified input before the decision, which is distinct from merely receiving a notice afterward.

5. change request. Turn 10. The change request records the proposed alteration for review and decision; preparing it does not itself approve the change.

E Dialogue gaps 6-10

Pages 19-20

6. approval gate. Turn 12. The approval gate requires the stated authorization before implementation and should receive a specific decision-ready proposal.

7. escalation path. Turn 14. The escalation path raises a delayed issue to the appropriate authority without converting silence into approval or bypassing the process.

8. cross-functional dependency. Turn 16. The cross-functional dependency links sales implementation with finance and legal review, so separate unilateral instructions could create an inconsistent process.

9. decision log. Turn 18. The decision log preserves the actual decision, authority, and conditions instead of replacing them with a color or an anticipated outcome.

10. delegated authority. Turn 20. Delegated authority is the specific power actually granted, which must not be inferred from coordinating a proposal or receiving an encouraging response.

F Transfer answers 1-2

Page 21

1. comments

Lead: "Legal has provided comments."

The supplied event is consultation input, not the steering decision.

2. outstanding

Consultant: "Steering approval remains outstanding."

The required decision has not yet occurred in the case.

F Transfer answers 3-4

Page 21

3. authority

Lead: "The status label overstated the authority."

It treated a consulted role's input as the approval assigned elsewhere.

4. record

Consultant: "Correct the decision record."

The record should preserve the actual input and unresolved approval status.

03 Briefing and language checks

Turning blunt disagreement into a workable decision

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What concrete constraint does Jordan identify?

B. Quality approval is outstanding
The brief identifies an uncompleted quality approval as the reason the Tuesday plan is challenged.

2. What is not established by the direct objection?

C. Hostile intent toward headquarters
The case explicitly does not establish hostility from the direct wording.

3. What should the team make explicit?

B. The concern, decision status, and discussion boundary
The task requires a shared understanding of the issue and respectful challenge, not assumptions about silence or identity.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which response best clarifies the objection?

C. Is the issue the Tuesday date or the integration goal?
This response checks the meaning without stereotyping or ignoring the stated constraint.

2. Which sentence protects the discussion boundary?

B. Challenge the plan with evidence, not the people
Task-focused challenge can be firm while personal attacks remain outside the agreed conduct boundary.

3. What should replace inferred consent?

C. A clear statement of agreement or remaining objection
Explicit responses make the actual agreement visible rather than relying on ambiguous silence.

4. Which closeout matches the facts?

B. Resolve quality approval before deciding the cutover
The actual unresolved approval must remain part of the cutover decision.

03 Conversation answers

Turning blunt disagreement into a workable decision

E Dialogue gaps 1-5

Pages 28-29

1. constructive dissent. Turn 2. Constructive dissent challenges the feasibility or reasoning of a proposal to improve the decision, rather than automatically rejecting the integration goal.

2. local constraint. Turn 4. The local constraint is the outstanding quality approval that limits the proposed cutover, not a general unwillingness to cooperate.

3. working norm. Turn 6. A working norm describes a team's actual meeting practice and should not be generalized into a fixed national personality.

4. challenge protocol. Turn 8. A challenge protocol sets a practical way to state the concern, evidence, and decision needed while preserving room for firm disagreement.

5. disagreement boundary. Turn 10. The disagreement boundary permits evidence-based challenge while excluding personal attacks or other inappropriate conduct.

E Dialogue gaps 6-10

Pages 28-29

6. repair statement. Turn 12. A repair statement corrects a misunderstanding and acknowledges its impact without requiring either person to abandon the substantive issue.

7. explicit agreement. Turn 14. Explicit agreement makes the actual acceptance or remaining objection clear instead of inferring consent from silence.

8. pre-read. Turn 16. A pre-read gives participants the relevant information before the meeting and can reduce misunderstandings about the proposal and unresolved conditions.

9. shared vocabulary. Turn 18. A shared vocabulary gives recurring status terms agreed meanings so different functions do not report incompatible states under the same word.

10. meeting closeout. Turn 20. The meeting closeout confirms actual decisions and open issues, here resolving the approval gap rather than authorizing an unconditional Tuesday cutover.

F Transfer answers 1-2

Page 30

1. approval

Consultant: "Silence does not establish approval."

The case supplies no explicit decision or required authorization.

2. check

Lead: "We need an explicit alignment check."

A direct check can establish the participants' actual positions and unresolved concerns.

F Transfer answers 3-4

Page 30

3. stated

Consultant: "Any remaining objection should be stated."

The team needs clear concerns rather than an assumption based on silence.

4. open

Lead: "The decision remains open."

The required approval has not occurred in the supplied situation.

04 Briefing and language checks

Handling HR differences without inventing assurances

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What change is proposed?

C. A role-title change
The brief identifies a proposed title change and leaves classification review incomplete.

2. Why is the spreadsheet assumption unsupported?

A. A job title alone does not determine exemption
The actual duties, compensation, and applicable requirements need review rather than a conclusion from the title.

3. What process currently remains in place?

A. Existing approved time recording
The brief explicitly retains the current approved time-recording process.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which correction should be made to the spreadsheet?

D. Title mapping does not establish exempt status
The spreadsheet should separate the proposed title from the unresolved legal classification.

2. Which employee message is accurate?

C. No classification change is approved; follow current time recording
The case retains the current approved process and supplies no authorized classification change.

3. What should HR examine?

A. Actual role facts and applicable requirements
Classification depends on the relevant facts and legal requirements rather than a naming preference.

4. How should personnel records be shared?

B. Through the authorized access and privacy process
Employee information still requires appropriate authority, controls, and applicable privacy handling.

04 Conversation answers

Handling HR differences without inventing assurances

E Dialogue gaps 1-5

Pages 37-38

1. job title. Turn 2. A job title is an organizational label and does not by itself establish exemption from applicable overtime requirements.

2. job architecture. Turn 4. Job architecture organizes roles and levels but must remain distinct from the legal assessment of pay classification.

3. actual duties. Turn 6. Actual duties describe the work genuinely performed and are relevant to the qualified classification assessment rather than relying only on a title or generic template.

4. salary basis. Turn 8. Salary basis is one potentially relevant compensation concept under applicable tests and does not replace the full requirements for a particular exemption.

5. exempt classification. Turn 10. Exempt classification is a legal status requiring the applicable assessment, which has not been completed or approved in the supplied case.

F Transfer answers 1-2

Page 39

1. title

Employee: "The chart shows a proposed title."

The chart changes the organizational label without deciding payroll classification.

2. incomplete

HR: "The classification review remains incomplete."

The scenario supplies no completed classification assessment or approval.

E Dialogue gaps 6-10

Pages 37-38

6. timekeeping. Turn 12. Timekeeping remains on the existing approved process in the case and should not be stopped based on an unapproved title or classification assumption.

7. Policy harmonization. Turn 14. Policy harmonization coordinates workplace arrangements while retaining the local requirements and actual review needed for each proposed change.

8. Local-law review. Turn 16. Local-law review assesses the actual jurisdiction-specific requirements and cannot be replaced by a global title convention or general presentation.

9. employee communication. Turn 18. Employee communication should state verified current status and the actual process rather than promise an unknown future or announce an unapproved change.

10. personnel data. Turn 20. Personnel data requires appropriate access and privacy handling even after acquisition; common ownership does not imply unrestricted distribution.

F Transfer answers 3-4

Page 39

3. process

Employee: "I should continue the approved timekeeping process."

The current approved recording instructions remain in effect.

4. authorization

HR: "An actual change needs the required authorization."

A proposed chart does not itself authorize a payroll or classification change.

05 Briefing and language checks

Running a cross-functional IT cutover conversation

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. Which test has passed?

A. Employee login to the new identity platform
The brief identifies a successful login test but leaves the invoice job unverified.

2. What dependency remains?

B. The invoice job uses a legacy service account
The scheduled job still depends on a legacy service identity.

3. Which action is not approved?

A. Broad shared-administrator access as a workaround
The case explicitly excludes broad shared-administrator access as an approved workaround.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which sponsor update is accurate?

B. Login passed; invoice posting remains dependent on the legacy account
The supplied tests establish only login success while a business-process dependency remains.

2. What should an acceptance check include here?

D. The invoice job's end-to-end result and reconciliation
The relevant business workflow must be tested beyond authentication and its outputs checked.

3. Which response preserves control?

C. Resolve access through the authorized least-privilege process
A legitimate fix needs appropriate access and review rather than a control bypass.

4. What is the status of the go-live decision?

B. Not supplied as approved
The case provides no authorization to proceed with the cutover or legacy retirement.

05 Conversation answers

Running a cross-functional IT cutover conversation

E Dialogue gaps 1-5

Pages 46-47

1. single sign-on. Turn 2. Single sign-on testing verifies the stated authentication flow but does not establish that every automated business process works.

2. service account. Turn 4. A service account is the identity used by the automated invoice job, whose dependency remains distinct from successful employee login.

3. legacy dependency. Turn 6. The legacy dependency is the job's reliance on the earlier identity setup, which must be addressed before assuming retirement is safe.

4. end-to-end test. Turn 8. An end-to-end test covers the full relevant workflow across connected components, including the automated posting process.

5. reconciliation. Turn 10. Reconciliation compares expected and resulting records or totals to establish whether the business process produced the required output.

E Dialogue gaps 6-10

Pages 46-47

6. least privilege. Turn 12. Least privilege limits access to the authorized task and is not satisfied by broadly sharing an unrestricted administrator identity.

7. go/no-go decision. Turn 14. The go/no-go decision is the explicit authorization based on readiness and controls, not a permission created by a calendar booking.

8. rollback plan. Turn 16. The rollback plan defines the authorized return to a workable prior state, including the relevant ownership and conditions.

9. User acceptance testing. Turn 18. User acceptance testing verifies business requirements through the relevant users and process, complementing technical component tests rather than being replaced by them.

10. data integrity. Turn 20. Data integrity concerns the accuracy and consistency of the resulting information and must remain a cutover requirement alongside availability and access controls.

F Transfer answers 1-2

Page 48

1. success

IT: "The job reported success."

The technical status message reports completion, not verified correctness of every output.

2. reconcile

Finance: "The totals do not reconcile."

The actual output and expected transactions differ in the supplied test.

F Transfer answers 3-4

Page 48

3. confirmed

IT: "Business acceptance is not yet confirmed."

The unresolved mismatch prevents claiming the supplied acceptance signoff is complete.

4. decision

Finance: "Record the discrepancy before the go/no-go decision."

The readiness decision needs the actual unresolved test evidence.

06 Briefing and language checks

Keeping customer communications and payment changes controlled

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. Which entity remains the invoicing entity under the supplied plan?

B. The existing US subsidiary
The approved transition plan retains the existing US subsidiary for invoicing.

2. What is the approved payment-instruction status?

D. No change has been approved
The brief states that payment instructions have not changed under the approved plan.

3. How should the unexpected email be treated?

D. As an unverified request needing established-channel verification
A separate unexpected account-change request requires verification rather than trust based on branding.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which customer statement matches the approved plan?

A. The existing US entity and payment instructions remain in use
The approved transition plan explicitly retains the existing entity and payment process.

2. Which verification route is appropriate?

B. Independently established trusted contact details
Independent verification avoids relying on information supplied by the unverified request itself.

3. What must be reviewed separately from branding?

A. Actual contract and invoicing-entity changes
Branding does not determine the legal or operational status of the customer arrangements.

4. What should the team avoid?

C. Sending unapproved replacement payment instructions
A new instruction must not be improvised while the actual request is unverified.

06 Conversation answers

Keeping customer communications and payment changes controlled

E Dialogue gaps 1-5

Pages 55-56

1. brand transition. Turn 2. The brand transition changes presentation and does not itself authorize a new payment destination or legal entity.

2. invoicing entity. Turn 4. The invoicing entity remains the existing US subsidiary in this case and should not be replaced merely because ownership or branding changed.

3. contracting entity. Turn 6. The contracting entity is the legal party to the agreement, which must be distinguished from a brand or parent company.

4. independent verification. Turn 8. Independent verification checks the request through a trusted source separate from the unverified message rather than allowing the sender to authenticate itself.

5. Payment redirection. Turn 10. Payment redirection changes where funds are sent and requires the actual authorization and control process, not an improvised response to conflicting emails.

F Transfer answers 1-2

Page 57

1. sender

Lead: "The reply came from the same sender."

The confirmation repeats the unverified source rather than adding an independent basis.

2. verification

Consultant: "That is not independent verification."

The request has not been checked through a trusted separate channel.

E Dialogue gaps 6-10

Pages 55-56

6. business email compromise. Turn 12. Business email compromise can involve convincing business details, so a familiar logo or name does not prove a payment-change request is authentic.

7. vendor master. Turn 14. The vendor master contains supplier particulars, and changes to it should use verified approved information rather than assumptions from a new brand announcement.

8. customer continuity. Turn 16. Customer continuity maintains the verified service and payment process while the team resolves the unexpected request through the proper controls.

9. customer-facing notice. Turn 18. The customer-facing notice must use approved facts so separate teams do not send contradictory statements about identity, payment, or service.

10. commercial continuity plan. Turn 20. The commercial continuity plan states the approved customer-facing arrangement and should distinguish current continuity from future changes requiring separate authorization.

F Transfer answers 3-4

Page 57

3. contact

Lead: "We need an established trusted contact."

The verification should use a previously reliable independent contact route.

4. unverified

Consultant: "The payment change remains unverified."

The supplied reply does not establish authorization or authenticity of the new instructions.

07 Briefing and language checks

Reporting integration synergies without double counting

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What is the gross realized saving for the three months?

C. USD 150,000
Three months at fifty thousand per month gives one hundred fifty thousand realized gross savings.

2. What is the net realized benefit on the supplied basis?

B. USD 60,000
Subtracting the ninety-thousand integration cost from one hundred fifty thousand gives sixty thousand.

3. Why must the two workstream reports be reconciled?

B. They list the same saving
The same underlying saving appears in both reports and must not be counted twice.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which headline is accurate?

D. 600,000 annualized run rate; 60,000 net realized in the stated period
This statement distinguishes the normalized rate from the actual net period result.

2. What is the double-counting correction?

D. Record the underlying benefit once while acknowledging both teams
Shared contributions do not create two separate economic benefits.

3. Which item is needed to interpret savings?

B. The agreed baseline and reporting basis
The baseline and basis determine what the reported change actually measures.

4. What does the annual run rate assume?

D. Continuation of the stated monthly rate for annualization
Annualization extends the current rate arithmetically and does not prove a realized or guaranteed future year.

07 Conversation answers

Reporting integration synergies without double counting

E Dialogue gaps 1-5

Pages 64-65

1. run-rate saving. Turn 2. Run-rate saving extends the stated monthly rate over a year and must not be reported as benefit already realized in only three months.

2. in-period realization. Turn 4. In-period realization identifies the benefit actually achieved during the three completed months, not the annualized extrapolation.

3. one-time integration cost. Turn 6. The one-time integration cost is the ninety-thousand expense assigned to the same period and basis, which must be included in the supplied net calculation.

4. net benefit. Turn 8. Net benefit subtracts the specified ninety-thousand cost from one hundred fifty thousand of gross realization, yielding sixty thousand here.

5. double counting. Turn 10. Double counting would record the same underlying vendor saving twice merely because two workstreams contributed to it.

F Transfer answers 1-2

Page 66

1. forecast

Lead: "The amount is currently a forecast."

The figure concerns a future proposed change, not an achieved result.

2. outstanding

Finance: "The required approval remains outstanding."

The scenario says the change has not yet been approved.

E Dialogue gaps 6-10

Pages 64-65

6. benefit register. Turn 12. The benefit register records the unique underlying benefit, its contributors, owner, assumptions, and reporting status.

7. baseline. Turn 14. The baseline is the reference against which the reduction is measured and must be stated to make the saving interpretable.

8. Cost avoidance. Turn 16. Cost avoidance concerns preventing a prospective expense and may differ from reducing an existing baseline cost, so the methodology must distinguish them.

9. benefit bridge. Turn 18. The benefit bridge reconciles the stated basis and gross effects to the net result rather than presenting unrelated figures as interchangeable.

10. finance validation. Turn 20. Finance validation checks the figures, attribution, and methodology before the result is treated as an approved benefit report.

F Transfer answers 3-4

Page 66

3. realized

Lead: "No benefit has been realized."

No implementation or actual saving has occurred in the supplied case.

4. total

Finance: "Keep it out of the realized-benefit total."

A future forecast should not be counted as an already achieved benefit.

08 Briefing and language checks

Handing over to business-as-usual owners

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. How many stable days are required by this fictional plan?

A. Five consecutive days
The supplied acceptance criterion requires five consecutive stable operating days.

2. What is the reporting defect's status?

A. Open with a named finance owner
Assigning an owner does not establish that the defect has been fixed.

3. Why is immediate acceptance unsupported?

D. Only two of the required five stable days are complete
The stated acceptance condition remains unmet after only two stable days.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which status report is accurate?

C. Two stable days complete; acceptance condition unmet
This choice preserves the actual operating evidence and the unmet criterion.

2. What should happen to the defect at handover?

A. Retain its status, owner, next action, and review route
An unresolved item needs traceable ownership and follow-up rather than disappearance from the record.

3. What should knowledge transfer establish?

B. The receiving team's practical ability to operate the process
Knowledge transfer should support actual operational capability, not just document transmission.

4. What is required for an exception to the criterion?

C. The actual specified exception authority and process
A stated condition cannot be silently waived without the relevant authorization.

08 Conversation answers

Handing over to business-as-usual owners

E Dialogue gaps 1-5

Pages 73-74

1. acceptance criteria. Turn 2. The acceptance criteria require five consecutive stable days in this fictional plan, so two days do not establish completion.

2. service acceptance. Turn 4. Service acceptance is the actual authorized acceptance of the operation under the stated conditions, not a synonym for preparing to hand over.

3. defect backlog. Turn 6. The defect backlog records unresolved problems, and assigning an owner does not establish that the underlying defect has been fixed.

4. knowledge transfer. Turn 8. Knowledge transfer builds the receiving team's practical understanding and capability, rather than merely sending a document or naming a department.

5. runbook. Turn 10. The runbook must contain usable operational instructions and current responsibilities, not an escalation route that disappears after transition.

E Dialogue gaps 6-10

Pages 73-74

6. Support coverage. Turn 12. Support coverage defines when and how assistance is available, which must be agreed rather than inherited by assumption from the temporary project team.

7. Ownership transfer. Turn 14. Ownership transfer is an explicit handover of responsibility to the receiving role and should not be inferred solely from preparing documents.

8. open risk. Turn 16. An open risk remains an unresolved exposure and must be recorded even when an authorized decision accepts or transfers responsibility for it.

9. closure report. Turn 18. The closure report records completed scope, remaining obligations, and actual closure authority rather than implying that preparation equals completion.

10. post-integration review. Turn 20. The post-integration review evaluates outcomes after transition and remains distinct from administrative closure of the workstream.

F Transfer answers 1-2

Page 75

1. sent

Consultant: "The document has been sent."

Email delivery is the completed action supplied in the scenario.

2. pending

Operator: "Our practical review is still pending."

The receiving team has not yet checked the material or contacts.

F Transfer answers 3-4

Page 75

3. accepted

Consultant: "Responsibility has not been formally accepted."

No receiving-team acceptance is supplied by the document email alone.

4. transfer

Operator: "We need a usable handover, not only a file transfer."

Moving a file does not establish operational understanding or ownership.

09 Conversation answers

A requested extension does not keep a transition service running

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. standalone capability. Turn 3. Standalone capability requires the receiving operation to perform its defined function reliably without the temporary service, not merely produce an unchecked report.

2. extension request. Turn 5. An extension request proposes a change to the service period but does not establish that the other party has agreed to provide it.

3. service boundary. Turn 7. The service boundary defines the actual support included, so an extension of time would not automatically add new tasks or broader access.

4. exit criteria. Turn 11. Exit criteria state the evidence required before leaving the temporary arrangement, including reconciliation rather than merely generating a replacement report.

5. continuity risk. Turn 13. The continuity risk is the possible interruption or unreliable operation after support ends, which requires authorized resolution rather than an assumed extension.

6. transition plan. Turn 17. The transition plan must reflect confirmed service arrangements and actual replacement readiness rather than a requested extension being treated as completed.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. acknowledged

Consultant: "The request was acknowledged."

The seller confirmed receipt, not agreement to the changed service period.

2. agreed

Lead: "An extension has not been agreed."

The supplied facts contain no agreement changing the service duration.

3. time

Consultant: "Keep the original end time visible."

The current service end remains relevant until an authorized change occurs.

4. risk

Lead: "Escalate the continuity risk."

The possible service gap needs an explicit decision rather than an assumed extension.

10 Conversation answers

One handoff instant appears on two calendar dates

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. UTC-05:00. Turn 3. The originating timestamp explicitly uses UTC-05:00; the conversion depends on this supplied offset rather than an assumed seasonal city rule.

2. UTC+09:00. Turn 4. The receiving timestamp uses UTC+09:00, fourteen hours ahead of the supplied originating offset, placing the event on the next local date.

3. timestamp. Turn 6. A timestamp that includes the date, time, and offset identifies the intended instant more precisely than a date-only label.

4. handoff window. Turn 10. The handoff window specifies the agreed time available for the transfer and should be communicated consistently across calendars.

5. acceptance. Turn 12. Acceptance requires an explicit receiving commitment under the stated handoff process, not merely the existence of a calendar invitation.

6. change notice. Turn 16. The change notice communicates an actual schedule change, distinct from correcting two local representations of an unchanged instant.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. fourteenth

US lead: "Our local date is November fourteenth."

The originating timestamp explicitly falls on the fourteenth at the minus-five offset.

2. fifteenth

Receiving lead: "Our local date is November fifteenth."

Adding the fourteen-hour offset difference crosses midnight into the fifteenth.

3. unchanged

US lead: "The underlying instant is unchanged."

The two complete timestamps are supplied representations of the same instant.

4. offset

Receiving lead: "Always include the UTC offset."

The offset defines the conversion without guessing local seasonal clock rules.

11 Conversation answers

Two green delivery dashboards measure different events

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

1. metric definition. Turn 3. The metric definition specifies the event being measured, which differs between dispatch and customer arrival despite the shared dashboard label.

2. denominator. Turn 5. The denominator is the hundred orders in this sample, so the difference described here is the measured event rather than a different order count.

3. common baseline. Turn 7. A common baseline requires an agreed comparable definition before historical figures can support a combined trend or integration-effect claim.

4. data lineage. Turn 9. Data lineage traces the reported figure to the underlying records and transformations so the team can verify how each measure was produced.

5. measurement specification. Turn 13. The measurement specification records the agreed event, population, exclusions, and calculation rules rather than relying on a familiar but ambiguous label.

6. combined KPI. Turn 15. A combined KPI requires comparable definitions and supporting data; matching labels alone do not make two operational measures interchangeable.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. dispatch

Analyst: "Ninety-five percent met the dispatch promise."

The brief assigns ninety-five successful orders to dispatch timing.

2. arrival

Lead: "Eighty-two percent met the arrival promise."

The brief assigns eighty-two successful orders to customer-arrival timing.

3. different

Analyst: "The event definitions are different."

Warehouse departure and customer arrival are distinct operational events.

4. decline

Lead: "Do not infer an integration-related decline."

These unlike measures do not establish a comparable historical deterioration.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Protecting Day 1 business continuity

Separate milestones: Closing is complete; platform integration is not.

Identify dependency: Migration depends on readiness checks and the required authorization.

Report accurately: We are ready for the stated Day 1 scope, not every future integration change.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Clarifying integration decision rights

Separate support and approval: The sponsor supports the concept; the process change is not yet authorized.

Define your role: I can coordinate the proposal, but I cannot approve it.

Prevent duplicate instructions: We need one authorized instruction for the affected teams.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Turning blunt disagreement into a workable decision

Invite the constraint: Which part of the Tuesday plan will fail, and why?

Preserve dignity: I may have read your direct wording differently than you intended.

Close precisely: We have agreed to resolve the approval issue, not to proceed Tuesday regardless.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Handling HR differences without inventing assurances

Challenge the assumption: The title change does not establish overtime status.

Separate workstreams: Title alignment and payroll classification are different decisions.

Close the loop: Employees should receive an approved notice when an actual decision is made.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Running a cross-functional IT cutover conversation

Translate the risk: Employees can sign in, but invoice posting still depends on the old service.

Preserve controls: We need an authorized fix, not broad shared-administrator access.

Close the decision: Report the unresolved dependency before the go/no-go review.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Keeping customer communications and payment changes controlled

Separate identity and branding: The logo changed; the approved invoicing entity has not.

Use a trusted route: Confirm through contact details already independently established.

Close the handoff: Confirm the account owner, support route, and any actually authorized changes.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Reporting integration synergies without double counting

Label the measure: Six hundred thousand is the annualized run rate.

Prevent duplication: IT and procurement contributed to one saving, not two separate benefits.

Report the bridge: Show baseline, gross realization, included costs, and net result together.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Handing over to business-as-usual owners

Check the criterion: We have completed two stable days against a five-day requirement.

Make support usable: The receiving team needs the runbook and actual escalation contacts.

Close deliberately: Record completed scope, remaining obligations, and the authorized closure decision.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acceptance criteria verify acceptance criteria 68
access entitlement validate access entitlements 41
account handoff coordinate the account handoff 51
accountable role identify the accountable role 14
action owner confirm the action owner 6
action owner confirm the action owner 15
action owner confirm the action owner 24
action owner confirm the action owner 33
action owner confirm the action owner 42
action owner confirm the action owner 51
action owner confirm the action owner 60
action owner confirm the action owner 69
actual duties review actual duties 32
alignment check conduct an alignment check 24
approval gate complete the approval gate 14
approved change notice issue an approved change notice 33
authorized signatory verify the authorized signatory 51
baseline establish the savings baseline 59
benefit bridge prepare the benefit bridge 60
benefit owner name the benefit owner 59
benefit register update the benefit register 59
benefits enrollment coordinate benefits enrollment 32
brand transition coordinate the brand transition 50
business as usual transition to business as usual 68

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

business continuity protect business continuity 5
business email compromise recognize business-email-compromise risk 50
callback control use the callback control 50
challenge protocol define a challenge protocol 23
change freeze observe the change freeze 42
change request submit a change request 15
check-back complete a check-back 6
check-back complete a check-back 15
check-back complete a check-back 24
check-back complete a check-back 33
check-back complete a check-back 42
check-back complete a check-back 51
check-back complete a check-back 60
check-back complete a check-back 69
clarification request make a targeted clarification request 6
clarification request make a targeted clarification request 15
clarification request make a targeted clarification request 24
clarification request make a targeted clarification request 33
clarification request make a targeted clarification request 42
clarification request make a targeted clarification request 51
clarification request make a targeted clarification request 60
clarification request make a targeted clarification request 69
closure report prepare the closure report 69
commercial continuity plan follow the commercial continuity plan 51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

constructive dissent invite constructive dissent 23
consultation requirement verify consultation requirements 33
consulted stakeholder involve consulted stakeholders 14
continuity owner name the continuity owner 6
contract assignment review contract-assignment requirements 50
contracting entity identify the contracting entity 50
cost avoidance distinguish cost avoidance 59
critical service identify critical services 5
critical-path item identify a critical-path item 6
cross-functional dependency resolve cross-functional dependencies 15
customer consent verify customer-consent requirements 50
customer continuity protect customer continuity 50
customer-facing notice approve customer-facing notices 51
cutover plan the cutover 41
cutover window confirm the cutover window 41
data integrity protect data integrity 42
Day 1 readiness assess Day 1 readiness 5
Day 100 milestone review the Day 100 milestone 6
decision latency reduce decision latency 15
decision log update the decision log 14
decision norm clarify the decision norm 23
decision rights clarify decision rights 14
defect backlog maintain the defect backlog 68
delegated authority verify delegated authority 15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

dependency map the dependency 6
dis-synergy identify dis-synergies 60
disagreement boundary state the disagreement boundary 24
double counting prevent double counting 60
employee communication approve employee communications 33
end-to-end test run an end-to-end test 41
escalation contact verify the escalation contact 69
escalation path use the escalation path 14
executive sponsor brief the executive sponsor 14
exempt classification assess exempt classification 32
explicit agreement obtain explicit agreement 23
face-saving language use face-saving language 23
finance validation obtain finance validation 60
go/no-go decision make the go/no-go decision 42
governance charter review the governance charter 14
gross saving report the gross saving 59
headcount saving validate headcount savings 59
hypercare plan hypercare coverage 6
identity provider verify identity-provider dependencies 41
impact statement make an impact statement 23
in-period realization verify in-period realization 59
incident owner name the incident owner 68
independent verification perform independent verification 50
informed stakeholder notify informed stakeholders 14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

integration friction address integration friction 23
integration management office establish the integration management office 5
intent clarification seek intent clarification 23
interface mapping verify interface mapping 42
interim operating model document the interim operating model 5
invoicing entity confirm the invoicing entity 50
issue log maintain the issue log 15
job architecture align job architecture 32
job title harmonize job titles 32
knowledge transfer complete knowledge transfer 68
least privilege maintain least privilege 41
legacy dependency identify the legacy dependency 42
legal close confirm legal close 5
local constraint identify a local constraint 23
local-law review obtain local-law review 32
meeting closeout complete the meeting closeout 24
minimum operating requirement define minimum operating requirements 5
monitoring cadence agree the monitoring cadence 68
net benefit reconcile the net benefit 59
nonexempt classification verify nonexempt classification 32
novation obtain novation advice 50
one-time integration cost track one-time integration costs 59
open risk retain an open risk 68
operating budget confirm the operating budget 69

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

operational signoff secure operational signoff 68
overtime eligibility assess overtime eligibility 32
ownership transfer document ownership transfer 69
paid time off clarify paid-time-off arrangements 33
payment redirection investigate payment redirection 51
personnel data protect personnel data 33
policy harmonization plan policy harmonization 32
post-integration review schedule a post-integration review 69
pre-read circulate a focused pre-read 24
process owner confirm the process owner 14
procurement saving verify procurement savings 60
psychological safety support psychological safety 23
RACI matrix use the RACI matrix 14
RAID log reconcile the RAID log 15
readiness checkpoint hold a readiness checkpoint 5
realization date verify the realization date 59
reconciliation perform transaction reconciliation 41
remittance instruction verify remittance instructions 50
repair statement offer a repair statement 24
retention concern address retention concerns 33
revenue synergy assess revenue synergies 60
role mapping complete role mapping 32
rollback plan validate the rollback plan 41
run-rate saving distinguish run-rate savings 59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

runbook validate the runbook 68
salary basis review the salary basis 32
scope boundary state the scope boundary 6
scope boundary state the scope boundary 15
scope boundary state the scope boundary 24
scope boundary state the scope boundary 33
scope boundary state the scope boundary 42
scope boundary state the scope boundary 51
scope boundary state the scope boundary 60
scope boundary state the scope boundary 69
segregation of duties preserve segregation of duties 42
service acceptance obtain service acceptance 68
service account review service-account access 41
service desk brief the service desk 6
service-level commitment preserve service-level commitments 51
shared vocabulary establish a shared vocabulary 24
single sign-on test single sign-on 41
source attribution preserve source attribution 6
source attribution preserve source attribution 15
source attribution preserve source attribution 24
source attribution preserve source attribution 33
source attribution preserve source attribution 42
source attribution preserve source attribution 51
source attribution preserve source attribution 60

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

source attribution preserve source attribution 69
standalone capability establish standalone capability 5
standard operating procedure update the standard operating procedure 68
steering committee seek steering-committee approval 14
support coverage confirm support coverage 68
synergy substantiate the synergy 59
system migration sequence the system migration 41
tacit assumption surface a tacit assumption 23
target operating model define the target operating model 5
timekeeping maintain accurate timekeeping 32
transition exit approve transition exit 69
transition service agreement review the transition service agreement 5
user acceptance testing complete user acceptance testing 41
vendor master control vendor-master changes 50
working assumption challenge a working assumption 6
working assumption challenge a working assumption 15
working assumption challenge a working assumption 24
working assumption challenge a working assumption 33
working assumption challenge a working assumption 42
working assumption challenge a working assumption 51
working assumption challenge a working assumption 60
working assumption challenge a working assumption 69
working norm establish working norms 23
workstream lead the HR workstream 5

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] Deloitte. Integrated asset management and integration management office functions.

Open the original source

First-party practice context for Day 1 readiness, workstream coordination, transition services, and synergy tracking; the cases and figures are original. Checked 11 October 2026.

[2] US Department of Labor. Fact Sheet 17A.

Open the original source

Supports the distinction between a job title and actual exemption requirements. No salary threshold or classification determination is taught here. Checked 11 October 2026.

[3] NIST. Cybersecurity Framework 2.0.

Open the original source

Risk-governance and authorized-access context, not a prescriptive technical cutover procedure. Checked 11 October 2026.

[4] FBI. Business email compromise.

Open the original source

Supports independent verification of payment changes rather than relying on an apparent acquisition-related email alone. Checked 11 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

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